First Steps to Understanding

Balagah

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If you see any mistakes in this book, have any comments or suggestions, please feel free to contact us. Jazakallah.

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Foreword

بِسۡمِ ٱللَّهِ ٱلرَّحۡمَٰنِ ٱلرَّحِيمِ

All praise is due to Allah سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى, without whose help nothing is possible. Alhamdulillah, only through His grace and bounty, we present the second edition of 'First Steps to Understanding Balagah'.

Who is this book for?

The purpose of this book is to act as an introductory guide to the study of Balagah, the science of eloquence in Arabic.

Its target audience is students who have already acquired a foundation in the Arabic language, specifically in areas such as Nahw (grammar), Sarf (morphology), and Literature.

Resources

The following resources are available on our website to support learning and teaching:

- PDF of this book
- Video recordings and PowerPoints of the lessons from the first edition
- Downloadable exam papers

Acknowledgments

I would like to extend my most sincere appreciation to all those who made this project possible, especially my parents, teachers, the staff and students at Al-Qalam. May Allah سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى reward them all in this world and the Hereafter for their contributions and help. Ameen.

I ask Allah سُبْحَانَهُوَتَعَالَىٰ and I also request you all to ask Allah to accept this work, overlook its shortcomings and to make it a means of reward in the Hereafter.

Hashim Mohamed

27th June 2023

9th Zul-Hijjah, 1444

Introduction

The study of the Arabic language can be divided into three layers, namely: Grammar, Balagah, and 'Ijaz.

Grammar

Grammar encompasses Nahw (Syntax) and Sarf (Morphology). In Nahw, the initial discussion revolves around the إِعْرَابٌ of words and their position in a sentence. Sarf, on the other hand, focuses on the structure of words.

Balagah (الْبَلَاغَةُ)

Balagah (الْبَلَاغَةُ) delves into the intricacies of word usage, sentence structure, emphasis placement, speech length and brevity, and other related topics.

It explores, for instance, the appropriate word choice or sentence structure e.g. the positioning of a مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ in relation to the verb.

‘Ijaz (الْإِعْجَازُ)

'Ijaz (الْإِعْجَازُ) is the remarkable utilization of Balagah within the Quran, resulting in a text that is truly miraculous and unparalleled in its form.

Overview of the Science of Balagah

The field of Balagah comprises three distinct sub-sciences:

1) عِلْمُ الْمَعَانِيْ
2) عِلْمُ الْبَيَانِ
3) عِلْمُ الْبَدِيْعِ

The mastery of these three sub-sciences is crucial to comprehend the miraculous nature of the language used in the Quran.

Unit 1

عِلْمُ الْمَعَانِيْ

Introduction

The sub-science of عِلْمُ الْمَعَانِيْ deals with the aspects of Arabic language that are related to the meaning of words, sentences, and their structures. This unit will cover eight topics related to عِلْمُ الْمَعَانِيْ:

1) Parts of a Sentence
2) Types of Sentences
3) Word Order
4) Details of مَعْرِفَةٌ and نَكِرَةٌ
5) Restrictions
6) Joining Sentences
7) Length of Speech
8) Miscellaneous Rules

Part 1
Parts of A Sentence

An Arabic sentence is made up of two types of words:

1. عُمْدَةٌ
2. فَضْلَةٌ

عُمْدَةٌ

The عُمْدَةٌ are the essential parts of a sentence. Without these, a sentence would not be complete.

These are the مُسْنَدٌ إِلَيْهِ and مُسْنَدٌ.

مُسْنَدٌ إِلَيْهِ

The مُسْنَدٌ إِلَيْهِ is the subject of the sentence. This includes both the مُبْتَدَأٌ and فَاعِلٌ.

مُسْنَدٌ

The مُسْنَدٌ is the information regarding the subject. This includes the خَبَرٌ or فِعْلٌ.

فَضْلَةٌ

The remaining parts of a sentence are called فَضْلَةٌ or قَيْدٌ (Plural قُيُوْدٌ). All types of مَفْعُوْلٌ, حَالٌ, تَمْيِيْزٌ, مُسْتَثْنًى, نَوَاسِخُ, شَرْطٌ and words of نَفْيٌ are considered to be فَضْلَةٌ.

Even though the grammar of a sentence is complete without the فَضْلَةٌ, the meaning would not be complete. In fact, the فَضْلَةٌ are usually the focal point of the sentences.

﴿وَلَا تَقْرَبُوا الزِّنَىٰٓ﴾

Do not go near fornication.

In this verse, the word الزِّنَا is the مَفْعُوْلٌ بِهِ, a قَيْدٌ. Without this, the sentence, لَا تَقْرَبُوْا, would be grammatically complete. However, the intended meaning would not be conveyed.

Below are some examples of various قُيُوْدٌ.

مِثَالٌ	قَيْدٌ
﴿وَلَا تَقْرَبُوا الْفَوَاحِشَ﴾ *Do not come close to immoral acts.*	الْمَفْعُوْلُ بِهِ
﴿اذْكُرُوا اللّٰهَ ذِكْرًا كَثِيْرًا﴾ *Remember Allah abundantly.*	الْمَفْعُوْلُ الْمُطْلَقُ
﴿وَلَا تَقْتُلُوْٓا اَوْلَادَكُمْ خَشْيَةَ اِمْلَاقٍ ؕ﴾ *Do not kill your children for fear of poverty.*	الْمَفْعُوْلُ لَهُ
﴿قَالُوْا لَبِثْنَا يَوْمًا اَوْ بَعْضَ يَوْمٍ ؕ﴾ *They said, "We have stayed a day, or part of a day."*	الْمَفْعُوْلُ فِيْهِ
﴿فَوَرَبِّكَ لَنَحْشُرَنَّهُمْ وَالشَّيٰطِيْنَ﴾ *So, by your Lord! We will surely gather them along with the devils.*	الْمَفْعُوْلُ مَعَهُ
﴿لَا تَقْرَبُوا الصَّلٰوةَ وَاَنْتُمْ سُكٰرٰى﴾ *Do not go near Salah when you are intoxicated.*	حَالٌ
﴿فَلَنْ يُّقْبَلَ مِنْ اَحَدِهِمْ مِّلْءُ الْاَرْضِ ذَهَبًا﴾ *Even an Earth-full of gold shall never be accepted from any of them*	التَّمْيِيْزُ
﴿اَلْاَخِلَّآءُ يَوْمَئِذٍۢ بَعْضُهُمْ لِبَعْضٍ عَدُوٌّ اِلَّا الْمُتَّقِيْنَ ﴿٦٧﴾ ؕ﴾ *Friends, on that day, will become enemies to one another, except the God-fearing.*	الْمُسْتَثْنَى
﴿وَاَصْبَحَ فُؤَادُ اُمِّ مُوْسٰى فٰرِغًا ؕ﴾ *And the heart of the mother of Musa became restless.*	النَّوَاسِخُ
﴿وَاِنْ كُنْتُمْ فِيْ رَيْبٍ مِّمَّا نَزَّلْنَا عَلٰى عَبْدِنَا فَاْتُوْا بِسُوْرَةٍ مِّنْ مِّثْلِهٖ ۪﴾ *If you are in doubt about what We have revealed to Our servant, bring a Surah like this.*	الشَّرْطُ
﴿اَلَيْسَ اللّٰهُ بِاَحْكَمِ الْحٰكِمِيْنَ ﴿٨﴾ ؕ﴾ *Is Allah not the Greatest Ruler of all the rulers?*	النَّفْيُ

Part 2
Types of Sentences According to Grammar

A sentence can be analysed in two ways:

1) According to its grammar (Part 2)
2) According to its meaning (Part 3)

Types of Sentences According to Grammar

According to its grammar, there are two types of sentences:

1) جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ
2) جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ

In the study of Nahw, when a sentence starts with a noun, it is classified as a جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ regardless of the content of its خَبَرٌ. However, in Balagah, if a sentence begins with a noun and contains a فِعْلٌ in its خَبَرٌ, it will still be categorized as a جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ. This is because the focus of Balagah is on the meaning of the sentence, and the presence of a فِعْلٌ anywhere in the sentence gives the meaning of the verb.

	زَيْدٌ صَائِمٌ	زَيْنَبُ تَصُوْمُ	تَصُوْمُ زَيْنَبُ
عِلْمُ النَّحْوِ	اِسْمِيَّةٌ	اِسْمِيَّةٌ	فِعْلِيَّةٌ
عِلْمُ الْبَلَاغَةِ	اِسْمِيَّةٌ	فِعْلِيَّةٌ	فِعْلِيَّةٌ

A جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ represents a connection between the مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ, indicating that the مُبْتَدَأٌ possesses the characteristic described in the خَبَرٌ. For example, in the sentence الدَّرْسُ سَهْلٌ, we observe a relationship between the مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ i.e., the lesson being easy.

Tense of the Connections

The connections between the مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ can occur in any of the three tenses: past, present, or future.

Present Tense

The connection between the مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ can indicate a present tense link. This is the default tense of the جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ.

This type of connection is called ثُبُوْتٌ.

الرَّجُلُ قَائِمٌ

The man is standing.

Note

Sometimes, the present tense can depict a long-term meaning. This is called دَوَامٌ.

﴿اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ رَبِّ الْعٰلَمِيْنَ ۙ﴾

All praise is for Allah, Lord of the worlds.

Past Tense

The connection between the مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ can also indicate a past tense link.

﴿اِنَّ اِبْرٰهِيْمَ كَانَ اُمَّةً قَانِتًا لِّلّٰهِ حَنِيْفًا ؕ﴾

Surely, Ibrahim was an Ummah.

This type of connection is called ثُبُوْتٌ فِي الْمَاضِيْ.

Future Tense

The connection between the مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ can also indicate a future tense link.

﴿إِنَّ الْمُتَّقِيْنَ فِيْ جَنّٰتٍ وَّعُيُوْنٍ ۝٢٥﴾

Surely, the God-Fearing will be in gardens and springs.

This type of connection is called ثُبُوْتٌ فِي الْمُسْتَقْبِلِ.

Note

The meaning of a جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ with كَانَ as its verb defaults to a link that existed in the past and has since ended. However, كَانَ can also indicate a link that is ongoing, as demonstrated in the following scenarios:

a) When the subject is the word Allah.

﴿وَكَانَ اللّٰهُ عَلِيْمًا حَكِيْمًا﴾

Allah is ever Knowing, Wise.

Here, the verb كَانَ implies that Allah has always possessed these qualities and will continue to possess them for eternity.

b) When the subject possesses a quality inherently.

﴿وَكَانَ الْاِنْسَانُ عَجُوْلًا﴾

Man is prone to be hasty.

In this case, the verb كَانَ indicates that man is predisposed to this particular trait.

c) When the sentence shows a certain future event. This is known as the Prophetic perfect tense.

﴿إِنَّ الْبَاطِلَ كَانَ زَهُوْقًا﴾

Surely, falsehood is ever bound to vanish (by its very nature).

Here, the verb كَانَ implies that the vanishing of falsehood is inevitable and bound to happen in the future.

Types of Connections

The connections between the مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ can be of two types:

1. ثُبُوْتٌ (stative)
2. دَوَامٌ (continuous)

ثُبُوْتٌ (stative)

This refers to a connection without any reference to its duration.

دَوَامٌ (continuous)

This refers to the establishment of a long-lasting connection.

﴿اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ رَبِّ الْعٰلَمِيْنَ ۙ﴾

All praise is for Allah, Lord of the worlds.

In this verse, the connection between the مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ extends over a long period. This means that the quality of Allah being the Lord of the worlds is eternal.

جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ

A جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ shows the occurrence of an action.

There are two types of occurrences:

1. Single Occurrence (حُدُوْثٌ)
2. Repeated Occurrence (تَجَدُّدٌ)

Single Occurrence (حُدُوْثٌ)

حُدُوْثٌ is a single occurrence either in the past or future.

Simple Past Tense

﴿وَقَتَلَ دَاوٗدُ جَالُوْتَ﴾

And Dawud (David) killed Golliath.

Simple Future Tense

﴿ثُمَّ يَاْتِيْ مِنْۢ بَعْدِ ذٰلِكَ سَبْعٌ شِدَادٌ﴾

Then after that will come seven hard years.

Repeated Occurrence (تَجَدُّدٌ)

تَجَدُّدٌ is a repeated occurrence either in the past, present, or future.

Past Habitual Tense

﴿كَانَا يَاْكُلٰنِ الطَّعَامَ ؕ﴾

They used to eat food.

Present Habitual

﴿وَاللّٰهُ يَرْزُقُ مَنْ يَّشَآءُ بِغَيْرِ حِسَابٍ ۝٢١٢﴾

Allah gives whom He wills without counting.

Future Habitual

﴿وَلَكُمْ فِيهَا مَا تَشْتَهِيٓ أَنفُسُكُمْ وَلَكُمْ فِيهَا مَا تَدَّعُونَ ۝٣١﴾

And for you therein are whatever your souls desire, and for you therein is whatever you request.

Example

﴿وَإِذَا لَقُوا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا قَالُوٓا آمَنَّا ۚ وَإِذَا خَلَوْا إِلَىٰ شَيَاطِينِهِمْ ۙ قَالُوٓا إِنَّا مَعَكُمْ ۙ إِنَّمَا نَحْنُ مُسْتَهْزِئُونَ﴾

When they [the hypocrites] meet those who believe, they say, "We have entered Faith;" but when they are alone with their satans, they say, "Indeed, we are with you."

This verse contains two quotes from the hypocrites.

The first sentence is a جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ (آمَنَّا). When the hypocrites proclaimed their faith to the believers, it is hypocritical i.e. there is no ثُبُوْتٌ. Hence, their words are expressed using a جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ which depicts حُدُوْثٌ.

The second sentence is جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ (إِنَّا مَعَكُمْ). When the hypocrites express their affiliation with their evil companions, it accurately reflects their strong relationship, as it is based on evidence of their actions i.e. there is ثُبُوْتٌ. Hence, their words are expressed using a جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ indicating the permanence and continuity of their association i.e., depicts ثُبُوْتٌ and دَوَامٌ.

حُدُوْثٌ and تَجَدُّدٌ in Nouns

The concept of ثُبُوْتٌ, حُدُوْثٌ and تَجَدُّدٌ also applies to a شِبْهُ الْفِعْلِ (i.e. اِسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ, اِسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ and الصِّفَةُ الْمُشَبَّهَةُ بِاسْمِ الفاعِلِ).

Example

﴿وَاِذَا قَامُوْٓا اِلَى الصَّلٰوةِ قَامُوْا كُسَالٰى ۙ يُرَآءُوْنَ النَّاسَ﴾

And when they stand for Salah, they stand up lazily, only to show people

This verse portrays the salah of hypocrites in two ways: they are lazy, and they display their worship for show.

The first characteristic, laziness, is conveyed through a صِفَةٌ مُشَبَّهَةٌ بِاسْمِ الْفَاعِلِ which indicates a state of permanence, ثُبُوْتٌ. This shows that laziness is an enduring trait that persists throughout the entire prayer.

The second characteristic, showing off, is expressed through a verb that suggests recurrence or renewal, تَجَدَّدٌ. This shows that showing off is a behaviour that is repeated whenever there is an audience present.

Supplement: Interchanging فِعْلٌ مَاضٍ and فِعْلٌ مُضَارِعٌ

Using a فِعْلٌ مَاضٍ to Describe a Future Event

Sometimes, a فِعْلٌ مَاضٍ is used to describe a future event to indicate the certainty of that event.

﴿اَتٰٓى اَمْرُ اللّٰهِ فَلَا تَسْتَعْجِلُوْهُ﴾

The Event ordained by Allah will surely come to pass.

In this verse, the past tense verb أَتَى has been used in place of a مُضَارِعٌ to depict a future event. This emphasizes the inevitability of the future occurrence.

This style is commonly used in supplications:

جَزَاكَ اللهُ

The past tense of the verb جَزَى has been used in place of a مُضَارِعٌ to depict a future event. This emphasizes the hope of the speaker in the future occurrence.

May Allah reward you.

Using a فِعْلٌ مُضارِع to Describe a Past Event

Sometimes, a فِعْلٌ مُضَارِعٌ is used to describe a past event.

﴿فَفَرِيْقًا كَذَّبْتُمْ ۗ وَفَرِيْقًا تَقْتُلُوْنَ﴾

So, a faction (of Prophets) you denied, and a faction you kill.

In this verse, the past event of killing the messengers of Allah is described using the فِعْلٌ مُضَارِعٌ. This highlights the abomination of this action.

Part 3
Types of Sentences According to Meaning

According to its meaning, there are two types of sentences:

1) جُمْلَةٌ خَبَرِيَّةٌ
2) جُمْلَةٌ إِنْشَائِيَّةٌ

جُمْلَةٌ خَبَرِيَّةٌ

A جُمْلَةٌ خَبَرِيَّةٌ is a sentence which consists of information with a true or false value in accordance with reality.

For example, the sentence "The pen is broken" has a true or false value depending on whether the pen is broken or not.

﴿لَقَدْ اَرْسَلْنَا نُوْحًا اِلٰى قَوْمِهٖ﴾

Indeed, we sent Nooh to his people.

The sentence in this verse is a جُمْلَةٌ خَبَرِيَّةٌ; it comprises of information which can be checked with reality i.e. it has a true value.

﴿...لَيَقُوْلُوْنَ ۙ﴿١٥١﴾ وَلَدَ اللّٰهُ ۙ وَاِنَّهُمْ لَكٰذِبُوْنَ ﴿١٥٢﴾﴾

Indeed, they say, "Allah has given birth," and surely, they are liars.

The middle sentence in this verse is a جُمْلَةٌ خَبَرِيَّةٌ which has a false value; it is not in accordance with reality.

جُمْلَةٌ إِنْشَائِيَّةٌ

A جُمْلَةٌ إِنْشَائِيَّةٌ is a sentence which does not consist of information with a true or false value. Instead, it consists of commands, requests, etc.

For example, the sentence "Do not break the pen" is a command. It does not have a true or false value; it has no reality to be checked against.

﴿وَاَقِمِ الصَّلٰوةَ﴾

And establish salah.

Types of جُمْلَةٌ إِنْشَائِيَّةٌ

We will discuss the following types of جُمْلَةٌ إِنْشَائِيَّةٌ:

1) أَمْرٌ
2) نَهْيٌ
3) اِسْتِفْهَامٌ
4) تَمَنٍّ
5) تَرَجٍّ
6) نِدَاءٌ

Type 1: أَمْرٌ

Primary Usage of an أَمْرٌ

An أَمْرٌ is a type of word primarily used by the speaker, مُتَكَلِّمٌ, who assumes himself to be in authority, to issue an order to an addressee, مُخَاطَبٌ, whom he assumes is lower in rank.

Forms of الْأَمْرُ

There are four ways of giving an order:

1) صِيْغَةُ الأَمْرِ

﴿يٰيَحْيٰى خُذِ الْكِتٰبَ بِقُوَّةٍ ۖ﴾

Hold fast to the Scripture.

2) صِيْغَةُ الأَمْرِ لِلْغَائِب

﴿لِيُنْفِقْ ذُوْ سَعَةٍ مِّنْ سَعَتِهٖ ۖ﴾

A man of vast means should spend according to his vast means.

3) الْمَصْدَرُ

﴿وَبِالْوَالِدَيْنِ اِحْسَانًا﴾

Be good to parents

4) اِسْمُ الْفِعْلِ

﴿هَآؤُمُ اقْرَءُوْا كِتٰبِيَهْ ۝١٩﴾

Come here! Read my book.

Note

The مَصْدَرٌ and اِسْمُ الْفِعْلِ depict a more emphatic command in comparison to the standard صِيْغَةُ الْأَمْرِ.

Type 2: النَّهْيُ

Primary Usage of a نَهْيٌ

A نَهْيٌ is a type of word primarily used by the speaker, مُتَكَلِّمٌ, who assumes himself to be in authority, to issue a prohibition to an addressee, مُخَاطَبٌ, whom he assumes is lower in rank.

Forms of النَّهْيُ

There are two ways of giving a negative order:

1) صِيْغَةُ النَّهْيِ

﴿لَا تُشْرِكْ بِاللّٰهِ﴾

Do not associate anything with Allah.

2) صِيْغَةُ النَّهْيِ لِلْغَائِبِ

﴿وَلَا يَأْتَلِ أُولُوا الْفَضْلِ مِنْكُمْ وَالسَّعَةِ﴾

The men of grace and wealth among you should not take an oath against ...

Secondary Usages of الْأَمْرُ and النَّهْيُ

Sometimes الْأَمْرُ and النَّهْيُ are used for other than issuing a command or prohibition.

Some of these are explained below.

إِرْشَادٌ

An أَمْرٌ can be used for إِرْشَادٌ, giving advice or a recommendation.

﴿يٰٓاَيُّهَا الَّذِيْنَ اٰمَنُوْٓا اِذَا تَدَايَنْتُمْ بِدَيْنٍ اِلٰٓى اَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى فَاكْتُبُوْهُ﴾

O you who believe, when you transact a debt payable at a specified time, put it in writing.

إِبَاحَةٌ

An أَمْرٌ can be used for إِبَاحَةٌ, showing that something is permissible.

﴿يَٰٓأَيُّهَا النَّاسُ كُلُوْا مِمَّا فِي الْاَرْضِ حَلٰلًا طَيِّبًا﴾

O people, eat permissible good things out of what lies in the earth.

اِلْتِمَاسٌ

An أَمْرٌ can be used for اِلْتِمَاسٌ, making a request from a peer or someone superior.

﴿قَالَ ابْنَ اُمَّ اِنَّ الْقَوْمَ اسْتَضْعَفُوْنِيْ وَكَادُوْا يَقْتُلُوْنَنِيْ ۖ فَلَا تُشْمِتْ بِيَ الْاَعْدَآءَ وَلَا تَجْعَلْنِيْ مَعَ الْقَوْمِ الظّٰلِمِيْنَ ۝١٥٠﴾

He [Harun] said [to Musa], "My mother's son, the people took me as weak and were about to kill me. So do not let the enemies laugh at me, and do not count me with the wrong-doers."

دُعَاءٌ

An أَمْرٌ can be used for دُعَاءٌ, making a prayer to Allah.

﴿رَبَّنَا تَقَبَّلْ مِنَّا ۗ﴾

"Our Lord, accept from us!"

تَمَنٍّ

An أَمْرٌ can be used for تَمَنٍّ, wishing for something impossible or improbable.

﴿وَنَادَوْا يٰمٰلِكُ لِيَقْضِ عَلَيْنَا رَبُّكَ ۗ﴾

"O Malik [warden of the Hell], let your Lord make an end of us."

تَسْوِيَةٌ

An أَمْرٌ and نَهْيٌ can be used for تَسْوِيَةٌ, showing that two actions are equal.

﴿اِصْلَوْهَا فَاصْبِرُوْٓا اَوْ لَا تَصْبِرُوْا ۚ سَوَآءٌ عَلَيْكُمْ ۗ﴾

Whether you endure [it] patiently or impatiently, it is all the same for you.

Summary

Purpose of الْأَمْرُ	مُخَاطَبٌ	مُتَكَلِّمٌ	
وُجُوْبٌ Necessary	أَدْنَى [Lower in Authority]	أَعْلَى [Higher in Authority]	الْأَمْرُ
مَشْوَرَةٌ Advice	أَدْنَى	أَعْلَى	الْإِرْشَادُ
Permission	أَدْنَى	أَعْلَى	الْإِبَاحَةُ
Request	مُسَاوٍ [Equal]	مُسَاوٍ [Equal]	الْتِمَاسٌ
Request	أَعْلَى	أَدْنَى	الْتِمَاسٌ
الْتِجَاءُ الْمَعْبُوْدِ Prayer	أَعْلَى	أَدْنَى	الدُّعَاءُ
Impossible	×		التَمَنِّيْ
مَعْطُوْفٌ عَلَيْهِ and مَعْطُوْفٌ are equal	×		التَّسْوِيَةُ

Type 3: اِسْتِفْهَامٌ

اِسْتِفْهَامٌ is to ask a question. Below is a brief recap of the particles of اِسْتِفْهَامٌ.

Example	Meaning	
﴿ءَاَنْتُمْ اَعْلَمُ اَمِ اللّٰهُ ؕ﴾ *Do you know better or does Allah?*	Is/Are	أَ
﴿هَلْ عِنْدَكُمْ مِّنْ عِلْمٍ﴾ *Do you have any sure knowledge ...?*	Is/Are	هَلْ
﴿وَمَا تِلْكَ بِيَمِيْنِكَ يٰمُوْسٰى﴾ *And what is that in your right hand, O Musa?*	What	مَا
﴿مَنْ هُوَ اَشَدُّ مِنْهُ قُوَّةً﴾ *Who is stronger than us in power?*	Who	مَنْ
﴿مَتٰى هٰذَا الْوَعْدُ﴾ *When will this promise ...?*	When	مَتٰى
﴿اَيَّانَ يَوْمُ الدِّيْنِ﴾ *When shall be the Day of Recompense?*	When	أَيَّانَ
﴿كَيْفَ تُحْيِ الْمَوْتٰى﴾ *How do You give life to the dead?*	How	كَيْفَ
﴿اَيْنَ شُرَكَآؤُكُمُ﴾ *Where are those you claimed to be partners?*	Where	أَيْنَ
﴿اَنّٰى يَكُوْنُ لَهُ الْمُلْكُ عَلَيْنَا﴾ *How could he have kingship over us?*	How	أَنّٰى
﴿يٰمَرْيَمُ اَنّٰى لَكِ هٰذَا﴾ *Maryam, from where did you have this?*	From where	
﴿كَمْ لَبِثْتَ﴾ *How long did you remain?*	How many	كَمْ
﴿اَىُّ الْفَرِيْقَيْنِ خَيْرٌ مَّقَامًا﴾ *Which of the two groups is superior in its place?*	Which	أَيٌّ

Secondary Usages of اسْتِفْهَامٌ

An اسْتِفْهَامٌ can also be rhetorical i.e. intended for something other than a question.

In Arabic, there are different names for the different rhetorical uses of اسْتِفْهَامٌ. Some of these are mentioned below.

أَمْرٌ

An اسْتِفْهَامٌ can be used for أَمْرٌ, issuing a command.

﴿فَهَلْ اَنْتُمْ شٰكِرُوْنَ ۝٨٠﴾

So will you be grateful?

نَهْيٌ

An اسْتِفْهَامٌ can be used for نَهْيٌ, issuing a prohibition.

﴿اَتَخْشَوْنَهُمْ ۚ﴾

Do you fear them?

تَعَجُّبٌ

An اسْتِفْهَامٌ can be used for تَعَجُّبٌ, expressing amazement.

﴿وَقَالُوْا مَالِ هٰذَا الرَّسُوْلِ يَاْكُلُ الطَّعَامَ وَيَمْشِيْ فِي الْاَسْوَاقِ ۭ﴾

What sort of messenger is this who eats food and walks in the markets?

تَشْوِيْقٌ

An اسْتِفْهَامٌ can be used for تَشْوِيْقٌ, drawing attention to what follows.

﴿يٰٓاَيُّهَا الَّذِيْنَ اٰمَنُوْا هَلْ اَدُلُّكُمْ عَلٰي تِجَارَةٍ تُنْجِيْكُمْ مِّنْ عَذَابٍ اَلِيْمٍ ۝١٠ تُؤْمِنُوْنَ بِاللّٰهِ وَرَسُوْلِهٖ وَتُجَاهِدُوْنَ فِيْ سَبِيْلِ اللّٰهِ بِاَمْوَالِكُمْ وَاَنْفُسِكُمْ ۭ ذٰلِكُمْ خَيْرٌ لَّكُمْ اِنْ كُنْتُمْ تَعْلَمُوْنَ ۝١١﴾

Shall I tell you about a trade that saves you from a painful punishment?

تَعْظِيْمٌ

An اسْتِفْهَامٌ can be used for تَعْظِيْمٌ, showing greatness.

﴿مَنْ ذَا الَّذِىْ يَشْفَعُ عِنْدَهٗٓ اِلَّا بِاِذْنِهٖ ؕ﴾

Who can intercede with Him without His permission?

Type 4: تَمَنٍّ

تَمَنٍّ is to express desire for something impossible or improbable.

The main particle of تَمَنٍّ is لَيْتَ.

This is often preceded by يَا which is not translated.

﴿قَالَ يٰلَيْتَ قَوْمِيْ يَعْلَمُوْنَ ۝﴾

I wish my people knew.

Other Particles of تَمَنٍّ

The following particles are also used to express a تَمَنٍّ:

1) هَلْ

﴿فَهَلْ لَّنَا مِنْ شُفَعَآءَ فَيَشْفَعُوْا لَنَآ﴾

So, are there any intercessors for us who could intercede in our favour?

2) لَوْ

﴿مِّنْ قَبْلِ اَنْ يَّاْتِيَ اَحَدَكُمُ الْمَوْتُ فَيَقُوْلَ رَبِّ لَوْلَآ اَخَّرْتَنِيْٓ اِلٰٓى اَجَلٍ قَرِيْبٍ﴾

Would you have not spared us for a little more time?

Type 5: تَرَجٍّ

تَرَجٍّ is to express desire for something possible.

The following two words are used for this:

1) عَسٰى

﴿عَسَى اللّٰهُ اَنْ يَّاْتِيَنِيْ بِهِمْ جَمِيْعًاۗ﴾

Hopefully, Allah may bring them all together.

2) لَعَلَّ

﴿لَا تَدْرِيْ لَعَلَّ اللّٰهَ يُحْدِثُ بَعْدَ ذٰلِكَ اَمْرًا ۝١﴾

It may be that Allah brings about a new situation thereafter.

Secondary Uses of تَمَنٍّ and تَرَجٍّ

The particles of تَمَنٍّ and تَرَجٍّ can be interchanged.

﴿وَقَالَ فِرْعَوْنُ يٰٓاَيُّهَا الْمَلَاُ مَا عَلِمْتُ لَكُمْ مِّنْ اِلٰهٍ غَيْرِيْ ۚ فَاَوْقِدْ لِيْ يٰهَامٰنُ عَلَى الطِّيْنِ فَاجْعَلْ لِّيْ صَرْحًا لَّعَلِّيْٓ اَطَّلِعُ اِلٰٓى اِلٰهِ مُوْسٰى ۙ وَاِنِّيْ لَاَظُنُّهٗ مِنَ الْكٰذِبِيْنَ ۝٣٨﴾

And Fir‘aun (Pharaoh) said, “O Haman, make a tower for me, perhaps I could reach the ways - The ways to the heavens, and peek towards the God of Musa.

Even though this is something impossible, Fir‘aun expressed this idea giving the impression to those around him that is was possible. This was then expressed in the Quran using the word لَعَلَّ.

Type 6: نِدَاءٌ

نِدَاءٌ is to call someone. There are two particles of نِدَاءٌ:

1) أَ or أَيْ: these are used to call someone who is close .
2) يَا: this is used to call someone who is far.

﴿يَا آدَمُ﴾

O Adam!

Inverted Uses of the Particles of نِدَاءٌ

Someone who is close may be called via يَا to show abstract distance.

Similarly, someone far maybe be called via أ to show abstract proximity.

For example, when Musa عليه السلام held the beard of his brother Harun عليه السلام and reprimanded him for letting the Children of Israel worship the cow, Harun replied by saying:

﴿قَالَ يٰهٰرُوْنُ مَا مَنَعَكَ اِذْ رَاَيْتَهُمْ ضَلُّوْٓا ﴿٩٢﴾ اَلَّا تَتَّبِعَنِ ۗ اَفَعَصَيْتَ اَمْرِيْ ﴿٩٣﴾ قَالَ يَبْنَؤُمَّ لَا تَاْخُذْ بِلِحْيَتِيْ وَلَا بِرَاْسِيْ ۚ اِنِّيْ خَشِيْتُ اَنْ تَقُوْلَ فَرَّقْتَ بَيْنَ بَنِيْٓ اِسْرَآءِيْلَ وَلَمْ تَرْقُبْ قَوْلِيْ ﴿٩٤﴾﴾

Moses said, "O Aaron! What prevented you, when you saw them going astray, from following me? How could you disobey my orders?" He replied: O son of my mother, do not hold me by my beard, nor by my head.

Even though they were physically close, the word يَا is used to show the abstract distance between them.

Secondary Uses of نِدَاءٌ

Sometimes نِدَاءٌ is used for other than calling.

Some of these are explained below.

إِغْرَاءٌ

A نِدَاءٌ can be used for إِغْرَاءٌ; urging or inciting someone.

After the miraculous birth of Isa عليه السلام, Maryam عليها السلام brought him to the people. Assuming he was an illegitimate child, their initial reaction was of shock and amazement.

﴿ يَٰٓأُخۡتَ هَٰرُونَ مَا كَانَ أَبُوكِ ٱمۡرَأَ سَوۡءٖ وَمَا كَانَتۡ أُمُّكِ بَغِيّٗا ٢٨ ﴾

O sister of Harun, neither your father was a man of evil nor was your mother unchaste.

They addressed her as sister of Harun, to reprimand her that being from such a noble family it was not befitting of her to carry out such an act (according to their assumption).

تَلَطُّفٌ and مِزَاحٌ

A نِدَاءٌ can be used for تَلَطُّفٌ and مِزَاحٌ, jesting and playing.

Once Ali رضي الله عنه stormed out of his house after he had an argument with his wife, Fatima رضي الله عنها. When the Prophet ﷺ came to know of their argument, he set out looking for Ali رضي الله عنه and found him sleeping on the ground of the masjid covered in dust. To lighten the mood, the Prophet ﷺ addressed him saying:

يَا أَبَا تُرَاب

O Abu Turab (one covered in dust)

اِسْتِهْزَاءٌ

A نِدَاءٌ can be used for اِسْتِهْزَاءٌ, mocking.

﴿وَقَالُوْا يٰٓاَيُّهَا الَّذِىْ نُزِّلَ عَلَيْهِ الذِّكْرُ اِنَّكَ لَمَجْنُوْنٌ ۝٦﴾

They say, "O you to whom the Dhikr [the Qur'an] has been revealed, you are surely insane.

The people of Makkah did not believe that revelation came to the Prophet ﷺ. Hence, this statement of theirs was sarcastic.

Supplement: Interchanging جُمْلَةٌ خَبَرِيَّةٌ and جُمْلَةٌ إِنْشَائِيَّةٌ

A جُمْلَةٌ خَبَرِيَّةٌ and a جُمْلَةٌ إِنْشَائِيَّةٌ can be interchanged.

Using a خَبَرِيَّةٌ in Place of an أَمْرٌ and نَهْيٌ

In an أَمْرٌ or نَهْيٌ, the addressee is issued an instruction or prohibition. He then has the choice to carry it out or not.

In a خَبَرِيَّةٌ, a statement is issued regarding something that is going to be done or not going to be done as a matter of fact.

Therefore, by expressing a command as a خَبَرِيَّةٌ more emphasis is created.

This feature can occur with a فِعْلِيَّةٌ or اِسْمِيَّةٌ.

﴿وَاِذْ اَخَذْنَا مِيْثَاقَكُمْ لَا تَسْفِكُوْنَ دِمَآءَكُمْ وَلَا تُخْرِجُوْنَ اَنْفُسَكُمْ مِّنْ دِيَارِكُمْ ثُمَّ اَقْرَرْتُمْ وَاَنْتُمْ تَشْهَدُوْنَ ۝٨٤﴾

When We took a pledge from you: "You shall not shed the blood of one another, and you shall not drive one another out of your homes."

﴿فَمَنْ فَرَضَ فِيْهِنَّ الْحَجَّ فَلَا رَفَثَ وَلَا فُسُوْقَ وَلَا جِدَالَ فِي الْحَجِّ ۗ﴾

There should be no obscenity, no sin, and no quarrel in Hajj.

Using an إِنْشَائِيَّةٌ in Place of a خَبَرِيَّةٌ

An إِنْشَائِيَّةٌ may also be used in place of a خَبَرِيَّةٌ.

﴿قُلْ اَمَرَ رَبِّيْ بِالْقِسْطِ ۖ وَاَقِيْمُوْا وُجُوْهَكُمْ عِنْدَ كُلِّ مَسْجِدٍ وَّادْعُوْهُ مُخْلِصِيْنَ لَهُ الدِّيْنَ ۗ﴾

My Lord has commanded justice and that you should face Him only [during prayers] in every place of worship.

In this verse two commands are issued: to be just and to turn towards Allah at the time of prayer.

However, the second command is expressed via an إِنْشَائِيَّةٌ, in a style different to the first. This creates an emphasis on the second command.

Part 4
Sentence Order

Order within A Sentence

A جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ and جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ both have their regular grammatical structures which can be adjusted to create emphasis or focus.

Alteration of Word Order in a جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ

In a جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ the regular word order is as follows:

مُبْتَدَأٌ – خَبَرٌ

Sometimes, this order is not observed due to a grammatical necessity. This will not affect the Balagah of the sentence. For example, if the مُبْتَدَأٌ is نَكِرَةٌ and the خَبَرٌ is a شِبْهُ الْجُمْلَةِ, it is grammatically necessary to forward the خَبَرٌ.

فِيْ الْبَيْتِ رَجُلٌ

If there is no grammatical obligation to bring one word first, either can be fronted. However, the point being emphasised will be brought first.

﴿اَللّٰهُ رَبُّنَا وَرَبُّكُمْ ۖ﴾

Allah is our Lord and your Lord.

In this verse, because both words are معرفة, grammatically either can be brought first. However, the topic of discussion has been chosen to be the مُبْتَدَأٌ.

Sometimes the خَبَرٌ can be brought before the مُبْتَدَأٌ to give emphasis.

﴿لَكُمْ دِيْنُكُمْ وَلِيَ دِيْنِ ۝٦﴾

For you is your faith, and for me, my faith.

Alteration of Word Order in a جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ

In a جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ the regular word order is as follows:

فِعْلٌ – فَاعِلٌ – مَفْعُوْلٌ بِهِ

Sometimes the regular word order can be altered for various reasons. Some of these are explained below.

تَأْكِيْدٌ

A word can be fronted for تَأْكِيْدٌ, emphasis.

﴿إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِيْنُ ۝٥﴾

You alone do we worship

In this verse, the مَفْعُوْلٌ بِهِ is fronted to create emphasis. This is reflected in the word alone.

﴿وَهُمْ يَعْلَمُوْنَ ۝٤٥﴾

whilst they know

In this verse, the فَاعِلٌ, now the مُبْتَدَأٌ, is fronted to create emphasis.

سَجَعٌ

A word can be fronted for سَجَعٌ, keeping the rhythm of a sentence.

﴿خُذُوْهُ فَغُلُّوْهُ ۝٣٠ ثُمَّ الْجَحِيْمَ صَلُّوْهُ ۝٣١ ثُمَّ فِيْ سِلْسِلَةٍ ذَرْعُهَا سَبْعُوْنَ ذِرَاعًا فَاسْلُكُوْهُ ۝٣٢﴾

Seize him, then put a collar around his neck, and then, let him burn in the blazing fire. Thereafter, fasten him with a chain the measure of which is seventy hands.

In the last two verses, the مَفْعُوْلٌ has been fronted to keep the pattern of verses ending in ـه.

Alteration of Word Order Within Parts of a Sentence

If a part of a sentence is made up of two or more words joined via a حَرْفُ عَطْفٍ, one word must be brought before the other.

Below are some reasons for fronting one over the other.

تَرْتِيْبٌ حَقِيْقِيٌّ

A word can be fronted because of تَرْتِيْبٌ حَقِيْقِيٌّ, the natural order.

﴿لَا تَاْخُذُهٗ سِنَةٌ وَّلَا نَوْمٌ ؕ﴾

Neither dozing overtakes Him nor sleep.

In this verse, سِنَةٌ, dozing, is mentioned before نَوْمٌ, sleep. The written order is in line with the natural order.

تَرْتِيْبٌ رُتَبِيٌّ

A word can be fronted because of تَرْتِيْبٌ رُتَبِيٌّ, hierarchy.

وَاِذْ يَرْفَعُ اِبْرٰهٖمُ الْقَوَاعِدَ مِنَ الْبَيْتِ وَاِسْمٰعِيْلُ ؕ﴾

When Ibrahim was raising up the foundations of the House, along with Isma'il.

In this verse the name of Ismail عليه السلام is mentioned after Ibrahim عليه السلام and delayed to even after the مَفْعُوْلٌ بِهٖ. This is to depict the hierarchy between father and son pointing out Ibrahim عليه السلام as the main builder and Ismail عليه السلام as an assistant.

تَعْجِيْلُ الْمَسَرَّةِ

A word can be fronted because of تَعْجِيْلُ الْمَسَرَّةِ, bringing good news first.

﴿اِذْ قَالَ اللّٰهُ يٰعِيْسٰٓى اِنِّىْ مُتَوَفِّيْكَ وَرَافِعُكَ اِلَىَّ وَمُطَهِّرُكَ مِنَ الَّذِيْنَ كَفَرُوْا﴾

O 'Isa! I am to take you in full and to raise you towards Myself.

When Isa ﷺ was surrounded by those who wanted to kill him, Allah reassured him that he would not be killed.

The sentence “I am going to take you in full” i.e. elevate you with body and soul, is mentioned first as this was the most prevailing issue.

Order within Sentences

In a paragraph comprised of multiple sentences, one sentence must be brought before the other.

Below is one reason for fronting one sentence over another.

تَعْجِيْلُ الْمَسَرَّةِ

A word can be fronted because of تَعْجِيْلُ الْمَسَرَّةِ, bringing good news first.

﴿عَفَا اللّٰهُ عَنْكَ ۚ لِمَ اَذِنْتَ لَهُمْ﴾

(O Prophet,) Allah has forgiven you; why did you permit them (to stay in Madinah)

The sentence mentioning the Prophet’s pardon is mentioned even before mentioning the error. This was done to avoid him worrying about Allah’s displeasure.

Part 5
Details About مَعْرِفَةٌ and نَكِرَةٌ

A noun can be either مَعْرِفَةٌ or نَكِرَةٌ.

In this discussion we will touch on a few rules regarding the six types of مَعْرِفَةٌ and some rules about نَكِرَةٌ.

ضَمِيْرٌ

Below are some rules regarding the use of ضَمِيْرٌ, pronouns.

الْإِضْمَارُ مَقَامَ الْإِظْهَارِ

A 3rd person pronoun, ضَمِيْرُ الْغَائِبِ, is only used after an antecedent. However, a ضَمِيْرُ الْغَائِبِ is sometimes used without an antecedent. One reason for this is to highlight that the noun is well known and understood by all, and therefore does need to be mentioned to be understood.

﴿الٓمّٓ ۚ ۝١ تَنْزِيْلُ الْكِتٰبِ لَا رَيْبَ فِيْهِ مِنْ رَّبِّ الْعٰلَمِيْنَ ۝٢ اَمْ يَقُوْلُوْنَ افْتَرٰىهُ ۚ بَلْ هُوَ الْحَقُّ مِنْ رَّبِّكَ لِتُنْذِرَ قَوْمًا مَّآ اَتٰىهُمْ مِّنْ نَّذِيْرٍ مِّنْ قَبْلِكَ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَهْتَدُوْنَ ۝٣﴾

(This) revelation of the Book - in which there is no doubt - is from the Lord of the worlds. Is it that they (the disbelievers) say, "He (Muhammad ﷺ) has fabricated it."

الْإِظْهَارُ مَقَامَ الْإِضْمَارِ

After a noun has been mentioned, it is consequently referred to as a pronoun. However, sometimes the noun can be repeated. One reason for this is to highlight the grandeur of that thing.

﴿اَلْقَارِعَةُ ۝١ مَا الْقَارِعَةُ ۝٢ وَمَآ اَدْرٰىكَ مَا الْقَارِعَةُ ۝٣﴾

The Striking Event! What is the Striking Event? And what may let you know what the Striking Event is?

Even though the word الْقَارِعَةُ has been mentioned previously, it is repeated as a noun and not replaced with its pronoun هِيَ. This highlights the grandeur of الْقَارِعَةُ.

اِلْتِفَاتٌ

الْتِفَاتٌ is to change the person in repeated pronouns. For example, to change from 1st person to 2nd person.

﴿وَمَا لِيَ لَآ اَعۡبُدُ الَّذِیۡ فَطَرَنِیۡ وَاِلَیۡهِ تُرۡجَعُوۡنَ ﴿۲۲﴾﴾

What excuse do I have if I do not worship the One who has created me and to whom you will be returned?

In the above verse, the pronouns change from 1st person to 2nd person.

عَبَسَ وَتَوَلّٰۤی ﴿۱﴾ اَنۡ جَآءَهُ الۡاَعۡمٰی ﴿۲﴾ وَمَا یُدۡرِیۡكَ لَعَلَّهٗ یَزَّكّٰۤی ﴿۳﴾ اَوۡ یَذَّكَّرُ فَتَنۡفَعَهُ الذِّكۡرٰی ﴿۴﴾ اَمَّا مَنِ اسۡتَغۡنٰی ﴿۵﴾ فَاَنۡتَ لَهٗ تَصَدّٰی ﴿۶﴾

In the above verse, the pronouns change from 3rd person to 2nd person.

Note

The مُخَاطَبٌ pronoun can be used to make a general reference to any person, not just the person being spoken to.

«ذِكْرُكَ أَخَاكَ بِمَا يَكْرَهُ»

[Backbiting] is your talking about your brother in a manner which he does not like.

In this hadith, the pronoun you does not refer to a single addressee, rather it applies to any person who hears or reads it.

عَلَمٌ

An عَلَمٌ, a name, is used to refer to someone or something.

﴿مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُوْلُ اللّٰهِ ۗ﴾

Muhammad is the messenger of Allah.

However, names can be used to give additional implications if that name carries a special or unique meaning which fits the context.

For example, the name Abu Lahab literally means father of the flame. He was called this because he was very fair skinned with redness in his skin colour. His name is mentioned in the Quran where it fits the punishment he will receive.

﴿تَبَّتْ يَدَآ اَبِيْ لَهَبٍ وَّتَبَّ ۗ ﴿١﴾ مَآ اَغْنٰى عَنْهُ مَالُهٗ وَمَا كَسَبَ ۗ ﴿٢﴾ سَيَصْلٰى نَارًا ذَاتَ لَهَبٍ ۖ ﴿٣﴾﴾

May the two hands of Abu Lahab (the father of the flame) perish, and may he perish! … He will soon enter a Fire, full of flames.

An اسْمُ إِشَارَةٍ is primarily used to point to something.

Sometimes it can used for other reasons, some of which are mentioned below.

تَعْظِيْمٌ

To show the grandeur of the thing being spoken about.

﴿الٓمّٓ ۚ ﴿١﴾ ذٰلِكَ الْكِتٰبُ لَا رَيْبَ ۛۚ فِيْهِ ۛۚ هُدًى لِّلْمُتَّقِيْنَ ﴿٢﴾﴾

This Book

تَحْقِيْرٌ

To show the insignificance of the thing being spoken about.

﴿اَهٰذَا الَّذِىْ يَذْكُرُ اٰلِهَتَكُمْ ۚ﴾

Is this the one who talks of your gods?

An اسْمُ مَوْصُوْلٍ is primarily used when the name of the person or thing being discussed is not known, nor can it be pointed to.

For example, if someone does not know a person's name nor is he close enough to point at, the speaker would have to describe him as follows: "I saw that man in the shop who we met at the masjid."

Sometimes it can used for other reasons, a few of which are mentioned below.

تَعْلِيْلٌ

A مَوْصُوْلٌ can be used for تَعْلِيْلٌ, pointing out the reason for the ruling.

﴿وَقَالَ رَبُّكُمُ ادْعُوْنِيْٓ اَسْتَجِبْ لَكُمْ ۭ اِنَّ الَّذِيْنَ يَسْتَكْبِرُوْنَ عَنْ عِبَادَتِيْ سَيَدْخُلُوْنَ جَهَنَّمَ دٰخِرِيْنَ ۝٦٠﴾

Those who show arrogance against worshipping Me shall enter Hell in disgrace

In this verse, a مَوْصُوْلٌ is used instead of a noun. This is to show the reason for them entering the Hellfire.

تَنْبِيْهٌ عَلَى الْخَطَإِ

A مَوْصُوْلٌ can be used for تَنْبِيْهٌ عَلَى الْخَطَإِ, pointing out an error.

﴿اِنَّ الَّذِيْنَ تَدْعُوْنَ مِنْ دُوْنِ اللّٰهِ عِبَادٌ اَمْثَالُكُمْ فَادْعُوْهُمْ فَلْيَسْتَجِيْبُوْا لَكُمْ اِنْ كُنْتُمْ صٰدِقِيْنَ ۝١٩٤﴾

Those whom you invoke beside Allah are certainly slaves (of Allah) like you.

In this verse, a مَوْصُوْلٌ is used instead of a noun. This is to show the error in considering the idols to be gods.

تَعْظِيْمٌ

A مَوْصُوْلٌ can be used for تَعْظِيْمٌ, showing grandeur.

﴿فَاَتْبَعَهُمْ فِرْعَوْنُ بِجُنُوْدِهٖ فَغَشِيَهُمْ مِّنَ الْيَمِّ مَا غَشِيَهُمْ ۝٧٨﴾

So, they were encircled by that [huge wave] from the sea which overwhelmed them.

تَحْقِيْرٌ

A مَوْصُوْلٌ can be used for تَحْقِيْرٌ, showing insignificance.

﴿فَقْضِ مَآ اَنْتَ قَاضٍ ۗ﴾

So, decide whatever you must decide.

تَقْرِيْرُ الْغَرْضِ

A مَوْصُوْلٌ can be used for تَقْرِيْرُ الْغَرْضِ, emphasising the point being discussed.

﴿وَرَاوَدَتْهُ الَّتِيْ هُوَ فِيْ بَيْتِهَا عَنْ نَّفْسِهٖ﴾

And she, in whose house he was, seduced him towards herself.

In this verse, a مَوْصُوْلٌ is used instead of a noun. This is to highlight how Yusuf عليه السلام kept himself away from sin and avoided the temptation to do evil despite residing in her house and being well acquainted with her.

A مُضَافٌ is used to express ownership or attribution.

رَسُوْلُ اللهِ

the prophet of Allah

Secondary Uses of مُضَافٌ

Sometimes a مُضَافٌ is used for a reason besides showing ownership.

Some of these are explained below.

تَعْظِيْمٌ

A مُضَافٌ can be brought to show تَعْظِيْمٌ, greatness.

﴿وَاذْكُرْ عَبْدَنَا دَاوٗدَ ذَا الْاَيْدِ ۚ اِنَّهٗٓ اَوَّابٌ ﴿١٧﴾﴾

And remember Our servant Dawud عليه السلام.

By attributing the word servant to Allah, it shows the lofty status of Dawud عليه السلام.

تَحْقِيْرٌ

A مُضَافٌ can be brought to show تَحْقِيْرٌ, insignificance.

لُعِنَ عَبْدُ الدِّيْنَارِ وَلُعِنَ عَبْدُ الدِّرْهَمِ

The slave of the dinar is cursed, and the slave of the dirham is cursed.

By attributing the word slave to the dinar and dirham, it shows the lowly status of the servant.

A noun can be made مَعْرِفَةٌ by prefixing an ال. However, there are three types of ال, each conveying a unique meaning.

الْ الْعَهْدِيَّةُ

عَهْدٌ means acquaintance, familiarity or knowledge.

A noun with an الْ الْعَهْدِيَّةُ implies that the addressee is familiar with that noun. There are three types of الْ الْعَهْدِيَّةُ.

عَهْدٌ ذِكْرِيٌّ

If a word is used as نَكِرَةٌ and then repeated as مَعْرِفَةٌ, the عَهْدٌ will be known as عَهْدٌ ذِكْرِيٌّ.

﴿اِنَّآ اَرْسَلْنَآ اِلَيْكُمْ رَسُوْلًاۙ شَاهِدًا عَلَيْكُمْ كَمَآ اَرْسَلْنَآ اِلٰى فِرْعَوْنَ رَسُوْلًا ۝١٥ فَعَصٰى فِرْعَوْنُ الرَّسُوْلَ فَاَخَذْنٰهُ اَخْذًا وَّبِيْلًا ۝١٦﴾

We sent a messenger to Fir'awn, Then, Fir'awn disobeyed the messenger.

عَهْدٌ حُضُوْرِيٌّ

If the thing being spoken about is present, the عَهْدٌ will be known as عَهْدٌ حُضُوْرِيٌّ.

﴿اَلْيَوْمَ اَكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِيْنَكُمْ﴾

Today, I have completed your religion for you.

عَهْدٌ ذِهْنِيٌّ

If the addressee is familiar with the word even it has not been mentioned previously, the عَهْدٌ will be known as عَهْدٌ ذِهْنِيٌّ.

﴿فَمَنْ حَجَّ الْبَيْتَ اَوِ اعْتَمَرَ فَلَا جُنَاحَ عَلَيْهِ اَنْ يَّطَّوَّفَ بِهِمَا﴾

So whoever comes to the House for Hajj or performs 'Umrah.

Prior to this verse, the word بَيْت is not mentioned. However, it is known that الْبَيْت refers to the Ka'bah.

ال الجِنْسِيَّةُ

جِنْسٌ means species or type.

A noun with an الْ الجِنْسِيَّةُ implies the speaker is referring to the type, not a single specified member of the type.

A word with an الْ الجِنْسِيَّةُ can be used in two ways.

1. The word can refer to a general meaning or concept.

   ﴿وَجَعَلْنَا مِنَ الْمَآءِ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ حَيٍّ ۖ﴾

   We created from water every living thing.

   In this verse, water is being referred to in the general sense, not any individual type of water.

2. The word can refer an unspecified member of the type.

   ﴿وَاَخَافُ اَنْ يَّاْكُلَهُ الذِّئْبُ وَاَنْتُمْ عَنْهُ غٰفِلُوْنَ ﴿١٣﴾﴾

   I fear that a wolf may eat him up

   The word الذِّئْبُ has an الْ الجِنْسِيَّةُ and it is not referring to a specific wolf, rather any wolf. Therefore, it is translated as a wolf.

   This type of word will be مَعْرِفَةٌ grammatically, but نَكِرَةٌ in meaning.

ال الِاسْتِغْرَاقِيَّةُ

اِسْتِغْرَاقٌ means to encompass.

A noun with an الْ الِاسْتِغْرَاقِيَّةُ implies the speaker is referring to every member of the type, not a single member.

A word with an الْ الِاسْتِغْرَاقِيَّةُ can be used in two ways.

اِسْتِغْرَاقٌ حَقِيْقِيٌّ

اِسْتِغْرَاقٌ حَقِيْقِيٌّ means the word is referring to every single member.

﴿وَالْعَصْرِ ۝١ اِنَّ الْاِنْسَانَ لَفِيْ خُسْرٍ ۝٢﴾

Man is in a state of loss indeed, except those who believed and did righteous deeds

The word الْإِنْسَانُ refers to every member of mankind.

اِسْتِغْرَاقٌ عُرْفِيٌّ

اسْتِغْرَاقٌ عُرْفِيٌّ means the word is not referring to every single member absolutely, but rather only those members which are relative to the topic of conversation.

﴿وَجَآءَ السَّحَرَةُ فِرْعَوْنَ﴾

The sorcerers came to Pharaoh.

السَّحَرَةُ does not refer to every single member of the type, rather, it is limited to the sorcerers of Firawn's kingdom.

نَكِرَةٌ

A noun is brought as نَكِرَةٌ when the speaker or addressee is not familiar or acquainted with the person or thing being discussed, or when there is no benefit in mentioning it as معرفة.

﴿وَجَآءَ مِنْ اَقْصَا الْمَدِيْنَةِ رَجُلٌ يَّسْعٰى﴾

And there came a man running from the farthest part of the city.

In this verse, the main purpose is to show that one person came to them and warned them regarding mistreating the messengers. Hence, there was no need to mention the رجل as معرفة.

Secondary Usage of نَكِرَةٌ Words

Sometimes a word may be brought as نَكِرَةٌ for secondary reasons. Some of these are explained below.

إِخْفَاءُ الْأَمْرِ

To conceal the identity of someone.

﴿فَقَالَتْ هَلْ اَدُلُّكُمْ عَلٰٓى اَهْلِ بَيْتٍ يَّكْفُلُوْنَهٗ لَكُمْ وَهُمْ لَهٗ نٰصِحُوْنَ ۝١٢﴾

Shall I point out to you a family who will nurse him for you?

This sister of Musa عليه السلام did not wish to reveal the identity of her mother as that would have jeopardised Musa's عليه السلام safety; hence she kept it as نكرة.

تَنْوِيْعٌ

The speaker may wish to keep something unspecific so the addressees may choose as they wish.

﴿اِقْتُلُوْا يُوْسُفَ اَوِ اطْرَحُوْهُ اَرْضًا يَّخْلُ لَكُمْ وَجْهُ اَبِيْكُمْ﴾

Throw him at some place on earth.

تَكْثِيْرٌ

To show variety, i.e. a plural نكرة word in a sentence can show the meaning of كثير without actually having to add the صفة of كثير.

﴿وَاِنْ يُّكَذِّبُوْكَ فَقَدْ كُذِّبَتْ رُسُلٌ مِّنْ قَبْلِكَ ۗ﴾

Indeed, many messengers have been rejected before you.

In this verse and the verses before, Allah is consoling the Prophet ﷺ. There would be greater solace if many Prophets عليهم السلام had been through the same ordeal as the Prophet ﷺ. Therefore, the word many has been added into the translation.

تَعْظِيْمٌ

To convey the meaning of عظيم (great).

﴿يٰٓاَيُّهَا الَّذِيْنَ اٰمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللّٰهَ وَذَرُوْا مَا بَقِيَ مِنَ الرِّبٰٓوا اِنْ كُنْتُمْ مُّؤْمِنِيْنَ ۝٢٧٨ فَاِنْ لَّمْ تَفْعَلُوْا فَاْذَنُوْا بِحَرْبٍ مِّنَ اللّٰهِ وَرَسُوْلِهٖ ۚ﴾

But if you do not [give it up], then listen to the declaration of war from Allah and His Messenger.

In this verse, a warning is being issued. The context shows that war here is in the meaning of حرب عظيمة.

تَحْقِيْرٌ

To convey the meaning of حقير (insignificant).

﴿وَمَا الْحَيٰوةُ الدُّنْيَا فِي الْاٰخِرَةِ اِلَّا مَتَاعٌ ۝٢٦﴾

This life of the world in comparison to the hereafter is only a [momentary] benefit.

In this verse, the world is being showed as paltry. Hence متاع here in its نكرة form means متاع حقير.

Part 6
Restriction

The link between the مُسْنَدٌ إِلَيْهِ and مُسْنَدٌ can be restricted. This is called قَصْرٌ.

For example, the sentence, "Ahmad is happy" informs us regarding the link between Ahmad and happy. However, the sentence "Only Ahmad is happy" shows that the quality of being happy only applies to Ahmad, no one else.

Parts of a قَصْرٌ

A قَصْرٌ comprises of 3 elements.

1. مَقْصُوْرٌ

   This is the item or quality being restricted. e.g., happiness.

2. مَقْصُوْرٌ عَلَيْهِ

   This is the item or quality the مَقْصُوْرٌ is being restricted to. e.g., Ahmad.

3. أَدَاةُ قَصْرٍ

   This is the word used to create the قَصْرٌ. e.g., only

Relationship Between the مَقْصُوْرٌ and مَقْصُوْرٌ عَلَيْهِ

There are two types of relationships between the مَقْصُوْرٌ and مَقْصُوْرٌ عَلَيْهِ.

قَصْرُ الصِّفَةِ على الْمَوْصُوْفِ

Restricting a quality, صِفَةٌ, to one person or being, مَوْصُوْفٌ.

﴿لَآ اِلٰهَ اِلَّا هُوَ﴾

There is no god but Allah.

In this verse the quality of being a god is restricted to a single being, Allah.

This is called قَصْرُ الصِّفَةِ على الْمَوْصُوْفِ.

قَصْرُ الْمَوْصُوْفِ على الصِّفَةِ

Restricting a person or thing, مَوْصُوْفٌ, to one quality, صِفَةٌ.

﴿وَمَا مُحَمَّدٌ اِلَّا رَسُوْلٌ ۚ﴾

Muhammad is but a messenger.

In this verse, a person, Muhammad ﷺ, is restricted to one quality.

This is called قَصْرُ الْمَوْصُوْفِ على الصِّفَةِ.

The Scope of Qasr

There are of two types of قَصْرٌ.

قَصْرٌ حَقِيْقِيٌّ

قَصْرٌ حَقِيْقِيٌّ is an absolute restriction.

﴿لَآ اِلٰهَ اِلَّا هُوَ﴾

There is no god but Allah.

In this verse the restriction of god to a single being is absolute i.e. there is no god but Allah.

قَصْرٌ إِضَافِيٌّ

قَصْرٌ إِضَافِيٌّ is a relative restriction.

﴿وَمَا مُحَمَّدٌ اِلَّا رَسُوْلٌ ۚ﴾

Muhammad ﷺ is but a messenger.

In this example, the restriction is relative, not absolute. i.e. he is only a prophet, not an eternal being.

Note

قَصْرُ الْمَوْصُوْفِ عَلى الصِّفَةِ will always be إضافي because no being can have only one quality.

Ways of Creating قصر

There are different ways of restricting:

إِلَّا

Using a negative particle followed by the particle إِلَّا.

﴿وَمَا مُحَمَّدٌ اِلَّا رَسُوْلٌ ۚ﴾

Muhammad ﷺ is but a messenger.

إِنَّمَا

Using the particle إِنَّمَا.

﴿قَالُوْٓا اِنَّمَا نَحْنُ مُصْلِحُوْنَ ۝١١﴾

We are but reformers.

بَلْ and لَكِنْ

Using the حَرْفُ الْعَطْفِ of بَلْ.

﴿وَقَالُوْا قُلُوْبُنَا غُلْفٌ ۭ بَلْ لَّعَنَهُمُ اللّٰهُ بِكُفْرِهِمْ فَقَلِيْلًا مَّا يُؤْمِنُوْنَ ۝٨٨﴾

They said: "Our hearts are sealed" - rather, Allah has set a seal over them because of their disbelief

Using the حَرْفُ الْعَطْفِ of لَكِنْ.

﴿وَمَا قَتَلُوْهُ وَمَا صَلَبُوْهُ وَلٰكِنْ شُبِّهَ لَهُمْ ۭ﴾

They did not kill him, nor crucify him, but they were deluded by resemblance.

تَقْدِيْمٌ

Fronting a particular part of the sentence.

﴿اِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَاِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِيْنُ ۝٥﴾

You alone do we worship, and from You alone do we seek help.

Part 7
Joining Sentences Together

Joining two sentences via the حَرْفُ عَطْفٍ of وَاوٌ is called وَصْلٌ.
Joining two sentences without having the حَرْفُ عَطْفٍ of وَاوٌ or any other حَرْفُ عَطْفٍ is called فَصْلٌ.

Places of فَصْلٌ

Two sentences will be joint together without a حَرْفُ عَطْفٍ in two situations.

كَمَالُ الِاتِّصَالِ

كَمَالُ الِاتِّصَالِ occurs between two sentences when the second is a تَابِعٌ to the second.

1) بَدَلٌ

﴿وَاتَّقُوا الَّذِيٓ اَمَدَّكُمۡ بِمَا تَعۡلَمُوۡنَ ﴿۱۳۲﴾ اَمَدَّكُمۡ بِاَنۡعَامٍ وَّبَنِيۡنَ ﴿۱۳۳﴾ وَجَنّٰتٍ وَّعُيُوۡنٍ ﴿۱۳۴﴾﴾

And fear the One who has supported you with what you know. He has supported you with cattle and sons, and with gardens and springs.

2) بَيَانٌ i.e. it explains or clarifies the first.

﴿فَوَسۡوَسَ اِلَيۡهِ الشَّيۡطٰنُ قَالَ يٰۤاٰدَمُ هَلۡ اَدُلُّكَ عَلٰى شَجَرَةِ الۡخُلۡدِ وَمُلۡكٍ لَّا يَبۡلٰى ﴿۱۲۰﴾﴾

Then Satan instigated him. He said, "Adam, shall I guide you to the tree of eternity."

3) تَوْكِيْدٌ

﴿مَا هٰذَا بَشَرًا ؕ اِنۡ هٰذَاۤ اِلَّا مَلَكٌ كَرِيۡمٌ ﴿۳۱﴾﴾

He is no human being. He is but a noble angel.

شِبْهُ كَمَالِ الْاِتِّصَال

شِبْهُ كَمَالِ الْاِتِّصَال occurs between two sentences when the second answers a query which may arise from the first.

﴿وَمَآ اُبَرِّئُ نَفۡسِیۡ ۚ اِنَّ النَّفۡسَ لَاَمَّارَةٌۢ بِالسُّوۡٓءِ اِلَّا مَا رَحِمَ رَبِّیۡ ؕ﴾

And I do not absolve my inner self of blame. Surely, man's inner self often incites to evil.

After the first sentence a question could be posed: "Why do you not absolve your inner self of blame?" The second sentence answers that.

Places of وَصْلٌ

Apart from the cases of فَصْلٌ mentioned above, وَصْلٌ will take place.

﴿اِیَّاکَ نَعۡبُدُ وَاِیَّاکَ نَسۡتَعِیۡنُ ؕ۝۵﴾

You alone do we worship, and from You alone do we seek help.

Part 8
Length of Speech

A speaker may express his idea in one of three ways:

1. مُسَاوَاةٌ: a moderate way which is neither too brief nor too wordy.
2. إِيْجَازٌ: a concise manner expressing a meaning with lesser words than would usually be required.
3. إِطْنَابٌ: a lengthy manner expressing a meaning in more words than would usually be required.

Succinct		Wordy
إِيْجَازٌ	مُسَاوَاةٌ	إِطْنَابٌ

مُسَاوَاةٌ

﴿وَمَنْ يُّطِعِ اللّٰهَ وَرَسُوْلَهٗ يُدْخِلْهُ جَنّٰتٍ تَجْرِيْ مِنْ تَحْتِهَا الْاَنْهٰرُ خٰلِدِيْنَ فِيْهَا ۗ وَذٰلِكَ الْفَوْزُ الْعَظِيْمُ ۝١٣﴾

Whoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, He will admit him to gardens beneath which rivers flow, where he will live forever. That is a great success.

إِيْجَازٌ

There are two types of إِيْجَاز:

1. إِيْجَازُ قَصْرٍ
2. إِيْجَازُ حَذْفٍ

إِيْجَازُ قَصْرٍ

إِيْجَازُ قَصْرٍ is expressing an idea using relatively few words.

﴿وَلَكُمْ فِيهَا مَا تَشْتَهِيٓ أَنفُسُكُمْ وَلَكُمْ فِيهَا مَا تَدَّعُونَ ۝٣١﴾

And for you in Heaven is whatever your souls desire.

The words within this verse are few, but its meaning is very extensive.

إِيْجَازُ حَذْفٍ

إِيْجَازُ حَذْفٍ is to remove something from the text.

This is of two types:

1. حَذْفُ اخْتِصَارٍ
2. حَذْفُ اقْتِصَارٍ

حَذْفُ اخْتِصَارٍ

حَذْفُ اخْتِصَارٍ is removing a word, words, phrase or sentence which have a grammatical function in the sentence from which it was omitted.

For example, a جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ is comprised of a مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ. One of these can be removed if the context allows.

Below, are some types of حَذْفُ اخْتِصَارٍ.

1) مُبْتَدَأٌ

﴿وَمَآ اَدْرٰىكَ مَا هِيَهْ ۝١٠ ـــ نَارٌ حَامِيَةٌۢ ۝١١﴾

And what may let you know what that is?

[It is] A blazing Fire!

2) خَبَرٌ

﴿اُكُلُهَا دَآئِمٌ وَّظِلُّهَا ـــ﴾

Its food is everlasting and its shade [is also everlasting].

3) فِعْلٌ

﴿وَلَئِنْ سَاَلْتَهُمْ مَّنْ خَلَقَ السَّمٰوٰتِ وَالْاَرْضَ وَسَخَّرَ الشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ لَيَقُوْلُنَّ ـــ اللّٰهُ﴾

And if you ask them: Who created the heavens and the earth, and who subjugated the sun and the moon. They will say: Allah (created and subjugated them).

The verb اُذْكُرْ is commonly omitted.

﴿وَ ـــ اِذْ قَالَ مُوْسٰى لِقَوْمِهٖ﴾

And (remember) when Musa said to his people ...

4) فَاعِلٌ

﴿كَلَّآ اِذَا بَلَغَتِ ـــ التَّرَاقِيَ ۝٢٦﴾

When [the soul] reaches to the collar bone.

5) مَفْعُوْلٌ بِهِ

﴿فَذُوْقُوْا ــــ فَلَنْ نَّزِيْدَكُمْ اِلَّا عَذَابًا ۝٣٠﴾

Taste (the punishment), for we will only increase you in punishment.

6) حَرْفٌ

﴿قَالُوْا تَاللّٰهِ ــــ تَفْتَؤُا تَذْكُرُ يُوْسُفَ﴾

By God, you will not stop remembering Yusuf.

تَفْتَأُ is usually used in the negative i.e., مَا فَتِئَ or لَا يَفْتَئُ.

7) مُضَافٌ

﴿وَسْئَلِ ــــ الْقَرْيَةَ الَّتِيْ كُنَّا فِيْهَا﴾

Ask [the people of] the town.

8) مَنْعُوْتٌ

﴿وَعِنْدَهُمْ ــــ قٰصِرٰتُ الطَّرْفِ عِيْنٌ ۝٣٨﴾

And by their side there will be (wives) lowering their gazes.

9) نَعْتٌ

لَا صَلَاةَ لِمَنْ لَمْ يَقْرَأْ بِفَاتِحَةِ الْكِتَاب

There is no complete salah without the recitation of al-Fatihah.

10) جَوَابُ الشَّرْطِ

﴿قُلْ اَرَءَيْتُمْ اِنْ كَانَ مِنْ عِنْدِ اللّٰهِ ثُمَّ كَفَرْتُمْ بِهٖ ــــ مَنْ اَضَلُّ مِمَّنْ هُوَ فِيْ شِقَاقٍۢ بَعِيْدٍ ۝٥٢﴾

"Tell me, if it is from Allah, and still you reject it..."

11) جُمْلَةٌ

﴿۝٢٣ اِنِّيْٓ اٰمَنْتُ بِرَبِّكُمْ فَاسْمَعُوْنِ ۝٢٥ ــــ قِيْلَ ادْخُلِ الْجَنَّةَ ۭ قَالَ يٰلَيْتَ قَوْمِيْ يَعْلَمُوْنَ ۝٢٦ بِمَا غَفَرَ لِيْ رَبِّيْ وَجَعَلَنِيْ مِنَ الْمُكْرَمِيْنَ ۝٢٧﴾

Undoubtedly, I have believed in your Lord; so listen to me." [Thereafter when his people killed him] it was said to him, "Enter Paradise!"

حَذْفُ اقْتِصَارٍ

حَذْفُ اقْتِصَارٍ is to construct a sentence or paragraph in such a way that the addressee can deduce hidden meaning even though no word, words, phrases or sentences have been removed or hidden. Below are a few examples.

تَضْمِيْنٌ

تَضْمِيْنٌ is mentioning a verb with a مَفْعُوْلٌ بِهِ غَيْرُ صَرِيْحٍ of another verb to indicate towards its meaning.

دَعْ مَا يَرِيْبُكَ إِلٰى مَا لَا يَرِيْبُكَ

Leave what causes you doubt and turn to what does not cause you doubt.

This sentence encompasses the meaning of the verb اِذْهَبْ. This is understood from the phrase إِلَى مَا لَا يَرِيْبُكَ.

فِعْلٌ ١	دَعْ	مَا يَرِيْبُكَ
فِعْلٌ ٢	اِذْهَبْ	إِلَى مَا لَا يَرِيْبُكَ

اِكْتِفَاءٌ

اِكْتِفَاءٌ is to omit one of two things commonly associated relying on the listener to understand the second.

﴿بِيَدِكَ الْخَيْرُ ۖ إِنَّكَ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ ﴿٢٦﴾﴾

In your hand is all goodness. Indeed, you are capable of everything.

The word خَيْرٌ is commonly mentioned with شَرٌّ. However, in this verse, out of respect, the word شَرٌّ is not mentioned.

Implied Word	Mentioned Word
الشَّرُّ	الْخَيْرُ

اِحْتِبَاكٌ

اِحْتِبَاكٌ is mentioning two words explicitly, whilst relying on the context to understand their opposite or related.

﴿قُلْ اِنِّيْ لَآ اَمْلِكُ لَكُمْ ضَرًّا وَّلَا رَشَدًا ۝٢١﴾

Say: I do not have control of harm or guidance.

In this verse, the word ضَرًّا (harm) is mentioned along with رَشَدًا (guidance). The opposite of each can be understood; نَفْعًا (benefit) and ضَلَالًا (misguidance).

Implied Word	Mentioned Word
نَفْعًا	ضَرًّا
ضَلَالًا	رَشَدًا

Summary

- إِيْجَازٌ
  - قَصْرٌ
  - حَذْفٌ
    - اخْتِصَارٌ
      - حَذْفُ كَلِمَةٍ
      - حَذْفُ جُمْلَةٍ
    - اقْتِصَارٌ
      - تَضْمِيْنٌ
      - اكْتِفَاءٌ
      - احْتِبَاكٌ

إِطْنَابٌ occurs in various ways. Some are as follows:

ذِكْرُ الْخَاصِّ بَعْدَ الْعَامِّ

ذِكْرُ الْخَاصِّ بَعْدَ الْعَامِّ is to mention something specifically after something general which already includes it.

﴿حَافِظُوْا عَلَى الصَّلَوٰتِ وَالصَّلٰوةِ الْوُسْطٰى ۗ﴾

Take due care of all the prayers, and the middle prayer.

The word الصَّلَوَاتِ includes all prayers, but الصَّلَاةِ الْوُسْطَى is mentioned specifically to emphasise its importance.

ذِكْرُ الْعَامِّ بَعْدَ الْخَاصِّ

ذِكْرُ الْعَامِّ بَعْدَ الْخَاصِّ is to mention something generally even though it has been mentioned specifically before.

﴿رَبِّ اغْفِرْ لِيْ وَلِوَالِدَيَّ وَلِمَنْ دَخَلَ بَيْتِيَ مُؤْمِنًا وَّلِلْمُؤْمِنِيْنَ وَالْمُؤْمِنٰتِ ۗ﴾

My Lord, grant pardon to me, and to my parents, and to everyone who enters my home as a believer, and to all the believing men and believing women.

تَكْرَارٌ

تَكْرَار is to repeat a word or sentence.

﴿فَبِاَيِّ اٰلَاۤءِ رَبِّكُمَا تُكَذِّبٰنِ ۝٣٣﴾

So, which of the bounties of your Lord will you deny?

This verse is mentioned 31 times in the chapter.

تَذْيِيْلٌ

تَذْيِيْلٌ is to bring two sentences, one after the other, with the second emphasising the meaning of the first.

﴿وَقُلْ جَآءَ الْحَقُّ وَزَهَقَ الْبَاطِلُ ۭ اِنَّ الْبَاطِلَ كَانَ زَهُوْقًا ۝٨١﴾

Truth has come and falsehood has vanished.

Falsehood is surely bound to vanish.

تَتْمِيْمٌ

تَتْمِيْمٌ is to add a word which highlights the meaning of the sentence.

﴿وَيُطْعِمُوْنَ الطَّعَامَ عَلٰى حُبِّهٖ مِسْكِيْنًا وَّيَتِيْمًا وَّاَسِيْرًا ۝٨﴾

And they give food, out of their love for Him (Allah), to the needy, and the orphan, and the captive

The words عَلَى حُبِّهِ highlights the virtue of their spending.

اعْتِرَاضٌ

اعْتِرَاضٌ is to bring a sentence within another sentence.

﴿وَيَجْعَلُوْنَ لِلّٰهِ الْبَنٰتِ سُبْحٰنَهٗ ۙ وَلَهُمْ مَّا يَشْتَهُوْنَ ۝٥٧﴾

They ascribe daughters to Allah - Pure is He - and for themselves is what they desire!

اِحْتِرَاسٌ

اِحْتِرَاسٌ is to bring a word, phrase or sentence within another sentence to remove any misconception.

﴿وَاضْمُمْ يَدَكَ اِلٰى جَنَاحِكَ تَخْرُجْ بَيْضَاۗءَ مِنْ غَيْرِ سُوْۗءٍ اٰيَةً اُخْرٰى ۝٢٢ۙ﴾

Press your hand under your arm, and it will come out [brightly] white without any disease

The phrase مِنْ غَيْرِ سُوْۗءٍ prevents someone interpreting the whiteness of his hand as an illness.

التَّوْضِيْحُ بَعْدَ الْإِبْهَامِ

التَّوْضِيْحُ بَعْدَ الْإِبْهَامِ is to bring a word or pronoun ambiguously followed by its clarification.

Two occasions where this occurs are as follows:

1. ضَمِيْرُ الشَّأْنِ

   This is a pronoun which is brought at the beginning of the sentence without an antecedent.

   ﴿قُلْ هُوَ اللّٰهُ اَحَدٌ﴾

   Say: The truth is that Allah is One

2. التَّمْيِيْزُ الْمُحَوَّلُ

   This is a تَمْيِيْزٌ which was originally another slot in a sentence.

   ﴿وَاشْتَعَلَ الرَّأْسُ شَيْبًا﴾

   And my head has lit ablaze with grey hair.

   In this verse, the word شَيْبًا is a تَمْيِيْزٌ. Outside of the Quran, it would have been the فَاعِلٌ and the sentence would have read as follows:

   اشْتَعَلَ شَيْبُ الرَّأْس

   The white hair in my head has lit ablaze.

   This modified structure creates emphasis by attributing the blaze to the entire head, and not simply the hair.

Part 9
Miscellaneous Rules

In this section, a few miscellaneous literary features will be discussed.

تَجَاهُلُ الْعَارِفِ

تَجَاهُلُ الْعَارِفِ is a literary device which is used to express a statement as though the speaker is unaware of it, even though he is aware.

﴿وَاِنَّآ اَوۡ اِيَّاكُمۡ لَعَلٰى هُدًى اَوۡ فِىۡ ضَلٰلٍ مُّبِيۡنٍ ۝٢٤﴾

And We or you are either on the right path or in open error.

التَّغْلِيْبُ

التَّغْلِيْبُ is a literary device in which one word is used to represent two meanings.

There are various ways in which تَغْلِيْبٌ can occur:

1. Using a dual or plural form to represent different singular forms. For example, using الْقَمَرَانِ to represent both الْقَمَرُ and الشَّمْسُ.
2. Using one gender to represent both genders. For example, using أَبَوَانِ and وَالِدَانِ to refer to mother and father.
3. Using a term that is typically associated with the عُقَلَاءِ to encompass both the عُقَلَاءِ and غَيْرُ عَقَلَاءِ.

   ﴿اَلۡحَمۡدُ لِلّٰهِ رَبِّ الۡعٰلَمِيۡنَ ۝٢﴾

   Praise belongs to Allah, lord of the worlds.

   The word عَالَمِيْنَ is a plural usually used to refer to عُقَلَاءُ. However, in this verse it refers to both عُقَلَاءِ and غَيْرُ عَقَلَاءِ.

أُسْلُوْبُ الْحَكِيْمِ

أُسْلُوْبُ الْحَكِيْمِ is a literary device in which a question is not answered directly. Instead, an answer to a more suitable question is given.

﴿يَسْـَٔلُوْنَكَ عَنِ الْاَهِلَّةِ ۗ قُلْ هِيَ مَوَاقِيْتُ لِلنَّاسِ وَالْحَجِّ ۗ﴾

They ask you regarding the crescent. Say: It they are signs to mark fixed periods of time.

When the companions inquired about cause of the change in the moon, instead of directly addressing their initial query, Allah responded by providing information that was more pertinent to their concerns.

تَنْزِيْلٌ

تَنْزِيْلٌ is a literary device in which one thing is brought under the ruling of another. For example, speaking to a غَيْرُ عَاقِلٍ as if it were عَاقِلٌ.

﴿فَقَالَ اَلَا تَاْكُلُوْنَ ۚ﴿٩١﴾﴾

Ibrahim عليه السلام said (to the idols) Do you not eat.

In this verse, the verb تَأْكُلُوْنَ is used to address idols. However, without تَنْزِيْلٌ, the singular feminine form would normally have been used.

Unit 2

عِلْمُ الْبَيَانِ

Introduction

The sub-science of عِلْمُ الْبَيَانِ deals with the aspects of Arabic language that are related to the following three topics:

1) تَشْبِيْهٌ: similes
2) مَجَازٌ: metaphors
3) كِنَايَةٌ: allegories

Part 1
التَّشْبِيْهُ

A تَشْبِيْهٌ, simile, is a figure of speech that draws a comparison between two things. For example, "This lesson is like ABC."

Elements of a Simile

A تَشْبِيْهٌ typically consists of four elements:

1) The tenor, the thing being compared. This is known as the مُشَبَّهٌ.
2) The vehicle, the thing the tenor is being compared to. This is known as the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ.
3) The comparator. This is known as the أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ.
4) The event, the point of similarity or shared characteristic between the مُشَبَّهٌ and مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ. This is called وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ.

Example

الْقُرْآنُ كَالنُّوْرِ فِي الْهِدَايَةِ

The Quran is like light in the way it guides.

This is a تَشْبِيْهٌ which compares the Quran to light. This would be analysed as follows.

مُشَبَّهٌ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
الْقُرْآنُ	كـ	النُّوْرِ	فِي الْهِدَايَةِ

Benefits of a Simile

Similes have several purposes. They can make descriptions more vivid and engaging. For instance, saying "The water is like ice" is more evocative than simply stating "The water is cold" or "The water is very cold". Similes can also help us comprehend unfamiliar concepts by comparing them to something familiar to us.

Type of تَشْبِيْهٌ

The مُشَبَّهٌ and مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ are the core elements of تَشْبِيْهٌ. These are mentioned in every تَشْبِيْهٌ. These are known known as طَرَفَا التَّشْبِيْهِ.

The وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ and أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ are the secondary elements of تَشْبِيْهٌ. In some cases, they may be omitted.

Depending on the mention or omission of the وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ and أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ, a تَشْبِيْهٌ can by be categorised in two ways.

Categorisation 1: Mention and Omission of the وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ

A تَشْبِيْهٌ مُفَصَّلٌ is a تَشْبِيْهٌ in which the وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ is mentioned.

﴿وَإِنْ يَسْتَغِيثُوا يُغَاثُوا بِمَاءٍ كَالْمُهْلِ يَشْوِي الْوُجُوهَ﴾

And if they seek help, they are helped with water like oil dregs that scalds the faces.

This can be broken down as follows:

مُشَبَّهٌ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
مَاءٌ	كَ	الْمُهْلِ	يَشْوِي الْوُجُوهَ

A تَشْبِيْهٌ مُجْمَلٌ is a تَشْبِيْهٌ in which the وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ is omitted.

﴿يَخْرُجُونَ مِنَ الْأَجْدَاثِ كَأَنَّهُمْ جَرَادٌ مُنْتَشِرٌ ۝٧﴾

They will come out of the graves as though they are locusts spread all over.

This can be broken down as follows:

أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
كَأَنَّ	هُم	جَرَادٌ مُنْتَشِرٌ	–

Categorisation 2: Mention and Omission of the أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ

A تَشْبِيْهٌ مُرْسَلٌ is a تَشْبِيْهٌ in which the أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ is mentioned.

﴿ثُمَّ قَسَتْ قُلُوبُكُم مِّنۢ بَعْدِ ذَٰلِكَ فَهِيَ كَالْحِجَارَةِ أَوْ أَشَدُّ قَسْوَةً﴾

Then your hearts became hardened after that, being like stones or even harder.

This can be broken down as follows:

مُشَبَّهٌ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
هِيَ	كَ	الْحِجَارَةِ	–

A تَشْبِيْهٌ مُؤَكَّدٌ is a تَشْبِيْهٌ in which the أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ is omitted.

«الْمُؤْمِنُ مِرْآةُ الْمُؤْمِنِ ... يَكُفُّ عَلَيْهِ ضَيْعَتَهُ، وَيَحُوطُهُ مِنْ وَرَائِهِ»

A believer is the mirror of a believer ... He protects him against loss and defends him behind his back.

This can be broken down as follows:

مُشَبَّهٌ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
الْمُؤْمِنُ	–	مِرْآةُ الْمُؤْمِنِ	يَكُفُّ عَلَيْهِ ضَيْعَتَهُ، وَيَحُوطُهُ مِنْ وَرَائِهِ

Removing the أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ creates an emphasis, implying the مُشَبَّهٌ is the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ, not simply like it.

تَشْبِيْهٌ بَلِيْغٌ

A تَشْبِيْهٌ بَلِيْغٌ is a تَشْبِيْهٌ in which both the وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ and أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ are omitted.

﴿هُنَّ لِبَاسٌ لَّكُمْ وَأَنتُمْ لِبَاسٌ لَّهُنَّ﴾

They (your wives) are (like) clothing for you; and you are (like) clothing for them.

This can be broken down as follows:

مُشَبَّهٌ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
هُنَّ	–	لِبَاسٌ لَّكُمْ	–

مُضَافٌ – مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ as a تَشْبِيْهٌ بَلِيْغٌ

A تَشْبِيْهٌ بَلِيْغٌ may occur as a مُضَافٌ and مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ.

﴿وَكَذٰلِكَ جَعَلْنَا لِكُلِّ نَبِيٍّ عَدُوًّا شَيٰطِيْنَ الْاِنْسِ وَالْجِنِّ﴾

And so We have made for every prophet enemies — devilish humans and jinn.

This can be broken down as follows:

مُشَبَّهٌ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْه	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
الْإِنْسِ	–	شَيَاطِيْنُ	–

Summary

Below is a recap of the different types of تَشْبِيْهٌ.

تَشْبِيْهٌ (مُفَصَّلٌ مُرْسَلٌ)	تَشْبِيْهٌ مُجْمَلٌ (مُرْسَلٌ)	تَشْبِيْهٌ مُؤَكَّدٌ (مُفَصَّلٌ)	تَشْبِيْهٌ بَلِيْغٌ (مُجْمَلٌ مُؤَكَّدٌ)
زَيْدٌ كَالْأَسَدِ فِي الشَّجَاعَةِ	زَيْدٌ كَالْأَسَدِ	زَيْدٌ أَسَدٌ فِي الشَّجَاعَةِ	زَيْدٌ أَسَدٌ
مُشَبَّهٌ	مُشَبَّهٌ	مُشَبَّهٌ	مُشَبَّهٌ
مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ
وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ	✗	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ	✗
أَدَاة التَّشْبِيْهِ	أَدَاة التَّشْبِيْهِ	✗	✗

تَشْبِيْهٌ مَقْلُوْبٌ

The وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ is typically a quality that is greater, more familiar, or more well-known within the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ.

However, the مُشَبَّهٌ and مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ can be swapped to suggest that the original مُشَبَّهٌ possesses the quality to a greater extent than the original مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ. This is known as an inverted simile or تَشْبِيْهٌ مَقْلُوْبٌ.

﴿قَالُوْٓا اِنَّمَا الْبَيْعُ مِثْلُ الرِّبٰوا﴾

Trade is just like usury.

The disbelievers, to justify their practice of usury, claimed that usury is just like a normal transaction. The verse would have read: "Usury is just like trade". However, the مُشَبَّهٌ and مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ are swapped giving the impression that trade should be compared to usury, not the other way around.

	مُشَبَّهٌ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْه	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
التَّشْبِيْهُ الأَصْلِيُّ	الرِّبٰوا	مِثْلُ	الْبَيْعُ	فِي الْحِلِّ
التَّشْبِيْهُ الْمَقْلُوْبُ	الْبَيْعُ	مِثْلُ	الرِّبٰوا	–

تَشْبِيْهٌ ضِمْنِيٌّ

The elements of a تَشْبِيْهٌ may be mentioned over multiple sentences instead of a single structure.

فَـــإِنْ تَفُـــقِ الأنـــامَ وَأَنْـــتَ مِـــنْهُمْ فـــإِنَّ الْمِسْـــكَ بَعْـــضُ دَمِ الْغَـــزَالِ

If you excel all the creation whilst you remain one of them,
Then musk is also blood of a deer.

This can be broken down as follows:

	مُشَبَّهٌ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْه	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
التَّشْبِيْهُ الأَصْلِيُّ	أَنْتَ	مِثْلُ	الْمِسْكِ	

Part 2
الْمَجَازُ

A مَجَازٌ, metaphor, is a figure of speech that uses a word or phrase figuratively, rather than literally.

﴿قَدْ جَآءَكُم مِّنَ اللّٰهِ نُوْرٌ﴾

Indeed, a light has come to you from Allah.

In this verse, the word نُوْرٌ is not used literally, instead it is used metaphorically to refer to the Prophet ﷺ.

عَلَاقَةٌ

In a مَجَازٌ, there will be a link between the literal meaning and the metaphorical meaning. This is known as the عَلَاقَةٌ.

Types of مَجَازٌ

Depending on the عَلَاقَةٌ between the literal and metaphorical meaning, there are two types of مَجَازٌ:

1. اِسْتِعَارَةٌ

   This is a مَجَازٌ in which the عَلَاقَةٌ is تَشْبِيْهٌ.

2. مَجَازٌ مُرْسَلٌ

   This is a مَجَازٌ in which the عَلَاقَةٌ is something other than تَشْبِيْهٌ.

الِاسْتِعَارَةُ

An اِسْتِعَارَةٌ is a figure of speech in which a word or sentence is used metaphorically instead of literally, and the عَلَاقَةٌ between the literal and metaphorical meaning is تَشْبِيْهٌ.

There are two types of اِسْتِعَارَةٌ:

1. An اسْتِعَارَةٌ in a single word.
   This is called اسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ. This is also referred to as اِسْتِعَارَةٌ.
2. An اسْتِعَارَةٌ in an entire sentence.
   This is called اسْتِعَارَةٌ تَمْثِيْلِيَّةٌ.

اسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ

An اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ is a single word used metaphorically based on a تَشْبِيْهٌ.

﴿الٓرٰ ۟ كِتٰبٌ اَنْزَلْنٰهُ اِلَيْكَ لِتُخْرِجَ النَّاسَ مِنَ الظُّلُمٰتِ اِلَى النُّوْرِ ۙ﴾

This is a book We have sent down to you, so that you may deliver the people, out of darkness into the light.

In this verse, there are two اِسْتَعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ. Each of these stems from an implied تَشْبِيْهٌ.

مُشَبَّهٌ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْه	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ مُسْتَعَارٌ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
الضَّلَالَةُ	ك	الظُّلُمَاتِ	–
الْهِدَايَةُ	ك	النُّوْرِ	–

The اِسْتِعَارَةٌ was formed by removing the مُشَبَّهٌ and keeping the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ.

Types of اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ

An اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ can be analysed from three perspectives:

1. Type of مُسْتَعَارٌ
2. Elements Mentioned
3. Use of Extension

Categorisation 1: Type of مُسْتَعَارٌ

According to the word being used as the مُسْتَعَارٌ, an اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ is of two types:

1. اِسْتِعَارَةٌ أَصْلِيَّةٌ: This is an اِسْتِعَارَةٌ in which a noun i.e. اسْمٌ جَامِدٌ is used metaphorically.
2. اِسْتِعَارَةٌ تَبَعِيَّةٌ: This is an اِسْتِعَارَةٌ in which a verb or اِسْمٌ مُشْتَقٌّ is used metaphorically.

Look at the examples below.

❶ اِسْتِعَارَةٌ أَصْلِيَّةٌ	❷ اِسْتِعَارَةٌ تَبَعِيَّةٌ
خَطَبَ الْأَسَدُ The lion gave a lecture.	زَأَرَ الْخَطِيْبُ The lecturer roared.

In example 1, the noun أَسَدٌ is used metaphorically to refer to a brave person.

In example 2, the verb زَأَرَ is used metaphorically to refer to confident speech.

Categorisation 2: Elements Mentioned

According to the elements mentioned in an اسْتِعَارَةٌ, there are two types of اسْتِعَارَةٌ:

1. اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُصَرَّحَةٌ
2. اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مَكْنِيَّةٌ

اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُصَرَّحَةٌ

An اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُصَرَّحَةٌ, explicit metaphor, is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ in which the مُسْتَعَارٌ is the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ.

﴿الٓرۚ كِتٰبٌ اَنْزَلْنٰهُ اِلَيْكَ لِتُخْرِجَ النَّاسَ مِنَ الظُّلُمٰتِ اِلَى النُّوْرِۙ﴾

In this verse, the two مُسْتَعَارٌ are the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ of the original تَشْبِيْهٌ.

اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مَكْنِيَّةٌ

An اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مَكْنِيَّةٌ, implied metaphor, is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ in which the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ is omitted. Instead, a لَازِمٌ, an inseparable element, of the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ is mentioned.

﴿وَاِذَا الْكَوَاكِبُ انْتَثَرَتْ ۝٢﴾

And when the stars will scatter.

In this verse, the مُسْتَعَارٌ is the verb انْتَثَرَتْ. This is a لَازِمٌ of the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ, not the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ.

The original تَشْبِيْهٌ would be:

الْكَوَاكِبُ مِثْلُ الْجَوَاهِرِ فِيْ سِلْكِهَا

The stars are like beads in its thread.

مُشَبَّهٌ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْه	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ
الْكَوَاكِبُ	كـ	الْجَوَاهِرِ فِيْ سِلْكِهَا	–

The لَازِمٌ of the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ is the verb انْتَثَرَ.

Summary

The table below explains the elements mentioned in the different types of تَشْبِيْهٌ and اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ.

تَشْبِيْهٌ (مُفَصَّلٌ مُرْسَلٌ)	تَشْبِيْهٌ مُجْمَلٌ (مُرْسَلٌ)	تَشْبِيْهٌ مُؤَكَّدٌ (مُفَصَّلٌ)	تَشْبِيْهٌ بَلِيْغٌ (مُجْمَلٌ مُؤَكَّدٌ)	اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُصَرَّحَةٌ	اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مَكْنِيَّةٌ
زَيْدٌ كَالْأَسَدِ فِي الشَّجَاعَةِ	زَيْدٌ كَالْأَسَدِ	زَيْدٌ أَسَدٌ فِي الشَّجَاعَةِ	زَيْدٌ أَسَدٌ	جَاءَ أَسَدٌ	زَأَرَ زَيْدٌ
مُشَبَّهٌ	مُشَبَّهٌ	مُشَبَّهٌ	مُشَبَّهٌ	×	مُشَبَّهٌ
مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	×
وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ	×	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ	×	×	×
أَدَاة التَّشْبِيْهِ	أَدَاة التَّشْبِيْهِ	×	×	×	×
					لَازِمُ المُشَبَّهِ بِهِ

Categorisation 3: Extension

In an اسْتِعَارَةٌ, something may be mentioned which matches either the مُشَبَّهٌ or مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ. This is called a مُلَائِمٌ.

The lion entered the debate hall, and with one roar, he caused the opponents to accept defeat.

In this sentence, the word lion is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ used to refer to a brave man. The word roar is a مُلَائِمٌ of the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ.

مُلَائِمُ الْمُشَبَّهِ بِهِ	وَجْهُ الشَّبَهِ	مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ	أَدَاةُ التَّشْبِيْه	مُشَبَّهٌ
roar	--	lion		brave man

According to the مُلَائِمٌ mentioned in an اسْتِعَارَةٌ, there are two types of اسْتِعَارَةٌ.

1. اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُطْلَقَةٌ
2. اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُرَشَّحَةٌ

اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُطْلَقَةٌ

This is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ in which no مُلَائِمٌ is mentioned.

﴿الٓرٰ ۟ كِتٰبٌ اَنْزَلْنٰهُ اِلَيْكَ لِتُخْرِجَ النَّاسَ مِنَ الظُّلُمٰتِ اِلَى النُّوْرِ ۙ﴾

اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُرَشَّحَةٌ

An اِسْتِعَارَةٌ مُرَشَّحَةٌ is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ in which a مُلَائِمٌ of the مُشَبَّهٌ بِهِ is mentioned.

﴿اُولٰٓئِكَ الَّذِيْنَ اشْتَرَوُا الضَّلٰلَةَ بِالْهُدٰى ۠ فَمَا رَبِحَتْ تِّجَارَتُهُمْ﴾

Those are the people who purchased misguidance in exchange for guidance. And their transaction was not profitable.

The word اشْتَرَوْا is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ used to refer to exchange. Later in the verse, the word رَبِحَتْ is mentioned, which is a مُلَائِمٌ of the مَشَبَّهٌ بِهِ.

الِاسْتِعَارَةُ التَّمْثِيْلِيَّةُ

An اِسْتِعَارَةٌ تَمْثِيْلِيَّةٌ is a type of figurative language that uses a comparison to convey a message. For instance, the phrase "You are opening a can of worms" is used metaphorically to imply irreversible consequences.

﴿مَا مِنْ دَآبَّةٍ اِلَّا هُوَ اٰخِذٌۢ بِنَاصِيَتِهَا ؕ﴾

There is no creature, but He holds it by the forelock.

This verse explains that Allah has complete control over every creature.

Note

An اسْتِعَارَةٌ مُفْرَدَةٌ is the use of a single word in its metaphorical meaning, whilst the remaining remain in their literal meaning.

A اسْتِعَارَةٌ تَمْثِيْلِيَّةٌ is the use of an entire sentence in its metaphorical meaning.

الْمَجَازُ الْمُرْسَلُ

A الْمَجَازُ الْمُرْسَلُ is a type of figurative language where the relationship between the literal meaning of the word and the intended meaning is not based on تَشْبِيْهٌ, rather on something closely related to the literal meaning.

Below are some of the عَلَاقَةٌ of مَجَازٌ مُرْسَلٌ.

سَبَبِيَّةٌ

سَبَبِيَّةٌ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is the cause of the metaphorical meaning.

«اَلْمُسْلِمُ مَنْ سَلِمَ الْمُسْلِمُوْنَ مِنْ لِسَانِهِ وَيَدِهِ»

A Muslim is the one from whose tongue and hands Muslims are safe.

Literal Meaning	لِسَانٌ عَلَاقَةٌ	Metaphorical Meaning
tongue hands	سَبَبِيَّةٌ cause	words actions

مُسَبَّبِيَّةٌ

مُسَبَّبِيَّةٌ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is the result of the metaphorical meaning.

﴿وَيُنَزِّلُ لَكُمْ مِّنَ السَّمَآءِ رِزْقًا﴾

And He sends down provision for you from the sky.

Literal Meaning	رِزْقٌ عَلَاقَةٌ	Metaphorical Meaning
sustenance	مُسَبَّبِيَّةٌ result	rain

كُلِّيَّةٌ

كُلِّيَّةٌ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is the whole of the metaphorical meaning.

﴿يَجْعَلُوْنَ اَصَابِعَهُمْ فِيْٓ اٰذَانِهِمْ﴾

They thrust their fingers in their ears.

أَصَابِعُ		
Literal Meaning	**عَلَاقَةٌ**	**Metaphorical Meaning**
fingers	كُلِّيَّةٌ whole	fingertips

جُزْئِيَّةٌ

جُزْئِيَّةٌ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is a portion of the metaphorical meaning.

﴿اَوْ تَحْرِيْرُ رَقَبَةٍ﴾

Freeing of a neck.

رَقَبَةٌ		
Literal Meaning	**عَلَاقَةٌ**	**Metaphorical Meaning**
neck	جُزْئِيَّةٌ part	slave

اِعْتِبَارُ مَا كَانَ

اِعْتِبَارُ مَا كَانَ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is the past state of the metaphorical meaning.

﴿وَاٰتُوا الْيَتٰمٰٓى اَمْوَالَهُمْ وَلَا تَتَبَدَّلُوا الْخَبِيْثَ بِالطَّيِّبِ﴾

Give the orphans their property.

يَتَامَى		
Literal Meaning	**عَلَاقَةٌ**	**Metaphorical Meaning**
orphan	اِعْتِبَارُ مَا كَانَ past state	adult who was an orphan

اِعْتِبَارُ مَا يَكُوْنُ

اِعْتِبَارُ مَا يَكُوْنُ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is the future state of the metaphorical meaning.

﴿قَالَ اَحَدُهُمَآ اِنِّيْٓ اَرٰىنِيْٓ اَعْصِرُ خَمْرًا ۚ﴾

I have seen myself [in dream] pressing wine.

	خَمْرٌ	
Literal Meaning	**عَلَاقَةٌ**	**Metaphorical Meaning**
wine	اِعْتِبَارُ مَا يَكُوْنُ future state	grapes

مُقَارَبَةٌ

مُقَارَبَةٌ is an عَلَاقَةٌ in which the literal meaning is something near in time or space to the metaphorical meaning.

مَنْ تَرَكَهَا (الصَّلَاةَ) فَقَدْ كَفَرَ

Whoever leaves salah intentionally has (come close to) disbelieving.

	كَفَرَ	
Literal Meaning	**عَلَاقَةٌ**	**Metaphorical Meaning**
becomes a disbeliever	قُرْبٌ proximity	came close to becoming a disbeliever

الْمَجَازُ الْعَقْلِيُّ

الْمَجَازُ الْعَقْلِيُّ is an اسْتِعَارَةٌ in the link between the مُسْنَدٌ إِلَيْهِ and مُسْنَدٌ. i.e., to attribute the فِعْلٌ to someone or something that is not its actual فَاعِلٌ.

﴿إِنَّ فِرْعَوْنَ عَلَا فِي الْأَرْضِ ... يُذَبِّحُ أَبْنَآءَهُمْ﴾

Indeed, Fir'awn had become high-handed in the land ... slaughtering their sons

Fir'awn is described as slaughtering the sons of the Banu Israel. Although he may not have physically carried out the act himself, it is ascribed to him due to his command to his army to do so.

Supplement

المَجَازُ الِاشْتِقَاقِيُّ

الْمَجَازُ الْعَقْلِيُّ can also occur in مُشْتَقَّاتٌ i.e. one مُشْتَقٌّ can be used in the meaning of another.

اِسْمُ فَاعِلٍ in the Meaning of اسْمُ مَفْعُوْلٍ

An اِسْمُ فَاعِلٍ can carry the meaning of an اسْمُ مَفْعُوْلٍ.

﴿فَهُوَ فِي عِيشَةٍ رَّاضِيَةٍ ﴿٢١﴾﴾

He will be in an enjoyable life.

In this verse, the اسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ of رَاضِيَةٌ (happy) is used in the meaning of the اسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ i.e., مَرْضِيَّةٌ (enjoyable)

اِسْمُ مَفْعُوْلٍ in the Meaning of اسْمُ فَاعِلٍ

An اِسْمُ مَفْعُوْلٍ can carry the meaning of an اسْمُ فَاعِلٍ.

﴿حِجَابًا مَّسْتُورًا ﴿٤٥﴾﴾

A covering veil

In this verse, the اسْمُ الْمَفْعُوْلِ of مَسْتُوْرٌ (covered) is used in the meaning of the اسْمُ الْفَاعِلِ i.e., سَاتِرٌ (covering)

Part 3 الْكِنَايَةُ

A الْكِنَايَةُ, allegory, is a figure of speech in which the literal meaning of a sentence is not intended, even though it could be interpreted literally.

For example, the sentence "I don't have blood on my hands" is an allegory used to convey innocence, and it is not intended to be taken literally.

﴿قَالَتْ اَنّٰى يَكُوْنُ لِيْ غُلٰمٌ وَّلَمْ يَمْسَسْنِيْ بَشَرٌ وَّلَمْ اَكُ بَغِيًّا ۝٢٠﴾

Maryam said, "How shall I have a son while no human has ever touched me?"

In this verse the word "touched" is being used as an allegory to convey the meaning of cohabitation, rather than a literal touch.

Unit 3

عِلْمُ الْبَدِيْعِ

Introduction

The sub-science of عِلْمُ الْبَدِيْعِ deals with the aspects of Arabic which are related to embellishments; features that beautify the words or meaning of the sentence. These are called مُحَسِّنَاتٌ.

There are two types of مُحَسِّنَاتٌ:

1) مُحَسِّنَاتٌ مَعْنَوِيَّةٌ: embellishments related to meaning
2) مُحَسِّنَاتٌ لَفْظِيَّةٌ: embellishments related to words

Part 1
مُحَسِّنَاتٌ مَعْنَوِيَّةٌ

الطِّبَاقُ

الطِّبَاقُ is a literary device which involves bringing together opposites. This occurs in various forms.

الطِّبَاقُ with Nouns

طِبَاقٌ can take place with nouns.

﴿هُوَ الْاَوَّلُ وَالْاٰخِرُ وَالظَّاهِرُ وَالْبَاطِنُ ۚ وَهُوَ بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ عَلِيْمٌ ۝٣﴾

He is the First and the Last, and the Manifest and the Hidden.

الطِّبَاقُ with Verbs

طِبَاقٌ can take place with verbs.

﴿وَاَنَّهٗ هُوَ اَضْحَكَ وَاَبْكٰى ۝٤٣ وَاَنَّهٗ هُوَ اَمَاتَ وَاَحْيَا ۝٤٤﴾

... He is the One who makes laugh and makes weep, and that He is the One who gives death and gives life.

الطِّبَاقُ with a Mixture of Nouns and Verbs

طِبَاقٌ can take place with a mixture of nouns and verbs.

﴿وَمَنْ يُّضْلِلِ اللّٰهُ فَمَا لَهٗ مِنْ هَادٍ ۝٣٣﴾

The one whom Allah deprives of guidance, there is no one to guide.

مُرَاعَاةُ النَّظِيْرِ

مُرَاعَاةُ النَّظِيْرِ is a literary device which involves bringing similar items or elements together.

﴿اَلشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ بِحُسْبَانٍ ۝٥ وَّالنَّجْمُ وَالشَّجَرُ يَسْجُدٰنِ ۝٦﴾

The sun and the moon are [bound] by a [fixed] calculation, and shrubs and trees prostrate.

الْمُشَاكَلَةُ

الْمُشَاكَلَةُ is a literary device which involves expressing a meaning using a word for which it has not been coined. This occurs when two words come in proximity.

﴿فَاعْتَدُوْا عَلَيْهِ بِمِثْلِ مَا اعْتَدٰى عَلَيْكُمْ ۖ﴾

You may transgress against another like they have transgressed against you,

The term اِعْتَدَى means to transgress, exceed, or go beyond limits. This verse suggests that if someone were to transgress and harm another, the victim has the right to seek justice. The word اعتدى is used twice, first in its original meaning and secondly in the meaning of taking retribution.

التَّوْرِيَةُ

التَّوْرِيَةُ is a literary device which involves using a sentence that can have two different meanings, where the listener understands one meaning while the speaker intends another.

When Abu Bakr ﵁ was asked about the person accompanying him during the migration from Makkah to Madinah, instead of saying Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, he would reply:

هَذَا الرَّجُلُ يَهْدِينِي السَّبِيلَ

This man is showing me the path.

The listener would assume he meant a guide who was showing him the path to Madinah whilst he meant the one who was showing him the path to good. By doing this not only did he conceal the identity of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, but he also avoided lying.

تَأْكِيْدُ الذَّمِ بِمَا يُشْبِهُ الْمَدْحَ

تَأْكِيْدُ الذَّمِ بِمَا يُشْبِهُ الْمَدْحَ is a literary device which involves emphasizing a criticism in a way that makes it sound like a compliment.

﴿فَلَا صَدَّقَ وَلَا صَلّٰى ۝٣١ وَلٰكِنْ كَذَّبَ وَتَوَلّٰى ۝٣٢﴾

So [the denier of the Hereafter] neither believed, nor prayed, but rejected the truth and turned away [from it].

In this verse, the word but and the following sentence is used to create the expectation that the following sentence will mention something positive after the initial criticism, but instead another negative trait is mentioned, implying that everything about the person being described is inherently evil.

تَأْكِيْدُ الْمَدْحِ بِمَا يُشْبِهُ الذَّمَ

تَأْكِيْدُ الْمَدْحِ بِمَا يُشْبِهُ الذَّمَ is a literary device which involves emphasizing a praise in a way that makes it sound like a criticism.

﴿لَا يَسْمَعُوْنَ فِيْهَا لَغْوًا وَّلَا تَاْثِيْمًا ۝٢٥ اِلَّا قِيْلًا سَلٰمًا سَلٰمًا ۝٢٦﴾

They will hear neither an absurd talk in heaven, nor something leading to sin, but [they will hear] the words of Salam, Salam [as greetings].

In this verse, the word but and the following sentence is used to create the expectation that the following sentence will mention something negative after the initial praise, but instead another positive trait is mentioned, implying that everything about Heaven is good.

Part 2

مُحَسِّنَاتٌ لَفْظِيَّةٌ

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز is a literary device which involves concluding a text or speech with the initial topic or theme. This occurs in various forms.

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز Within A Verse

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز can take place within a verse.

﴿اَتَخْشَوْنَهُمْ ۚ فَاللّٰهُ اَحَقُّ اَنْ تَخْشَوْهُ﴾

Were you were fearing them? Allah is more entitled to be feared by you.

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز Within A Chapter

رَدُّ الصَّدْرِ عَلَى الْعَجْز can take place within a surah.

The beginning and end of سُوْرَةُ الْقَلَمِ comprise of the same topic: refuting the allegation that the Prophet is insane.

The first verses are as follows:

﴿نٓ وَالْقَلَمِ وَمَا يَسْطُرُوْنَ ۝١ مَآ اَنْتَ بِنِعْمَةِ رَبِّكَ بِمَجْنُوْنٍ ۝٢﴾

By the pen and what they write, with the grace of your Lord, you are not insane.

The final verses are as follows:

﴿وَاِنْ يَّكَادُ الَّذِيْنَ كَفَرُوْا لَيُزْلِقُوْنَكَ بِاَبْصَارِهِمْ لَمَّا سَمِعُوا الذِّكْرَ وَيَقُوْلُوْنَ اِنَّهٗ لَمَجْنُوْنٌ ۝٥١ وَمَا هُوَ اِلَّا ذِكْرٌ لِّلْعٰلَمِيْنَ ۝٥٢﴾

And they say, "He is a madman indeed." And it is nothing else but a Reminder for all the worlds.

السَّجَعُ

السَّجَعُ is a literary device which involves ending each verse or sentence with a similar pattern or rhyme.

﴿طٰهٰ ۝١ مَآ اَنْزَلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْقُرْاٰنَ لِتَشْقٰٓى ۝٢ اِلَّا تَذْكِرَةً لِّمَنْ يَّخْشٰى ۝٣ تَنْزِيْلًا مِّمَّنْ خَلَقَ الْاَرْضَ
وَالسَّمٰوٰتِ الْعُلٰى ۝٤ اَلرَّحْمٰنُ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ اسْتَوٰى ۝٥ لَهٗ مَا فِى السَّمٰوٰتِ وَمَا فِى الْاَرْضِ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا وَمَا
تَحْتَ الثَّرٰى ۝٦ وَاِنْ تَجْهَرْ بِالْقَوْلِ فَاِنَّهٗ يَعْلَمُ السِّرَّ وَاَخْفٰى ۝٧ اَللّٰهُ لَآ اِلٰهَ اِلَّا هُوَ ۚ لَهُ الْاَسْمَآءُ الْحُسْنٰى
۝٨﴾

الْجِنَاسُ

الْجِنَاس is a literary device which involves using words with same or similar pronunciations but different meanings.

﴿وَيَوْمَ تَقُوْمُ السَّاعَةُ يُقْسِمُ الْمُجْرِمُوْنَ ۙ مَا لَبِثُوْا غَيْرَ سَاعَةٍ ۭ﴾

And on the Day when the Hour takes place, the sinners will swear that they did not remain [in the graves] more than one moment.

الْقَلْبُ

اَلْقَلْبُ is a literary device which involves structuring a sentence or phrase in a way that it can be read forwards and backwards.

﴿كُلٌّ فِيْ فَلَكٍ يَّسْبَحُوْنَ ۝٤٠﴾

Each one in an orbit.

قَلْبٌ takes place in the first three words of this verse.

ك	ل	ف	ي	ف	ل	ك

بَرَاعَةُ الْاِسْتِهْلَالِ

بَرَاعَةُ الْاِسْتِهْلَالِ is a literary device which involves using an eye catching statement to initiate a text or speech.

﴿سُبْحٰنَ الَّذِیْۤ اَسْرٰی بِعَبْدِهٖ لَیْلًا مِّنَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ اِلَی الْمَسْجِدِ الْاَقْصَا الَّذِیْ بٰرَكْنَا حَوْلَهٗ لِنُرِیَهٗ مِنْ اٰیٰتِنَا ؕ اِنَّهٗ هُوَ السَّمِیْعُ الْبَصِیْرُ ۝۱﴾

Glorious is He Who made his servant travel by night from Al-Masjid-ul-Haram to Al-Masjid-ul-Aqsa whose surroundings We have blessed.

حُسْنُ الْخِتَامِ

حُسْنُ الْخِتَامِ is a literary device which involves using an eye-catching statement to end a text or speech.

﴿دَعْوٰىهُمْ فِیْهَا سُبْحٰنَكَ اللّٰهُمَّ وَتَحِیَّتُهُمْ فِیْهَا سَلٰمٌ ۚ وَاٰخِرُ دَعْوٰىهُمْ اَنِ الْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ رَبِّ الْعٰلَمِیْنَ ۝۱۰﴾

And the end of their call will be, “All praise be to Allah, the Lord of all the worlds.”

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سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ

أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلٰهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ

أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ